



Plan and implement a series of training events

D1.HRD.CL9.05

D1.HHR.CL8.05

Trainee Manual



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Trainee Manual



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Introduction to trainee manual

To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT/CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainees' chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his/her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service

- Front Office
- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he/she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and/or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and/or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.

Unit descriptor

Plan and implement a series of training events

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Plan and implement a series of training events in a range of settings within the hotel and travel industries workplace context.

Unit Code:

D1.HRD.CL9.05

D1.HHR.CL8.05

Nominal Hours:

30

Element 1: Plan a series of training events

Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Verify identified training need
- 1.2 Prioritise identified training need
- 1.3 Determine resources available to support training events to address identified training need
- 1.4 Identify training events that will address identified workplace training need
- 1.5 Determine availability of learners to attend and participate in identified training events
- 1.6 Involve stakeholders in planning activities
- 1.7 Develop a schedule for implementing identified training events
- 1.8 Develop an operational plan to support the implementation of identified training events
- 1.9 Share the implementation plan for training events with stakeholders
- 1.10 Encourage identified learners to engage with established training events

Element 2: Implement a series of training events

Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Provide identified support for learners to attend identified training events
- 2.2 Provide required resources for supervisors to maintain required service levels during identified training events
- 2.3 Advise learners of attendance requirements as required by the organisation
- 2.4 Capture feedback from learners on individual training events
- 2.5 Modify planned schedule of training events on the basis of feedback and other issues arising
- 2.6 Attend training events to monitor and evaluate their implementation
- 2.7 Maintain contact with training event organisers/providers

Element 3: Review planning and implementation of a series of training events

Performance Criteria

- 3.1 Evaluate the impact of attendance at training events
- 3.2 Assess the value-for-money provided by engagement with training events
- 3.3 Identify ways in which more cost-effective use of training events could be effected
- 3.4 Prepare a report on the use of training events within the organisation

Assessment matrix

Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance – Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 1: Plan a series of training events				
1.1	Verify identified training need	1.1	1, 2	1
1.2	Prioritise identified training need	1.2	3	2
1.3	Determine resources available to support training events to address identified training need	1.3	4	3
1.4	Identify training events that will address identified workplace training need	1.4	5, 6	4
1.5	Determine availability of learners to attend and participate in identified training events	1.5	7	5
1.6	Involve stakeholders in planning activities	1.6	8	6
1.7	Develop a schedule for implementing identified training events	1.7	9	7
1.8	Develop an operational plan to support the implementation of identified training events	1.8	10, 11	8
1.9	Share the implementation plan for training events with stakeholders	1.9	12	9
1.10	Encourage identified learners to engage with established training events	1.10	13, 14	10

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 2: Implement a series of training events				
2.1	Provide identified support for learners to attend identified training events	2.1	15, 16	11
2.2	Provide required resources for supervisors to maintain required service levels during identified training events	2.2	17,18	12
2.3	Advise learners of attendance requirements as required by the organisation	2.3	19	13
2.4	Capture feedback from learners on individual training events	2.4	20, 21	14
2.5	Modify planned schedule of training events on the basis of feedback and other issues arising	2.5	22	15
2.6	Attend training events to monitor and evaluate their implementation	2.6	23, 24	16
2.7	Maintain contact with training event organisers/providers	2.7	25	17
Element 3: Review planning and implementation of a series of training events				
3.1	Evaluate the impact of attendance at training events	3.1	26, 27	18
3.2	Assess the value-for-money provided by engagement with training events	3.2	28	19
3.3	Identify ways in which more cost-effective use of training events could be effected	3.3	29	20
3.4	Prepare a report on the use of training events within the organisation	3.4	30	21

Glossary

Term	Explanation
Affective	Refers to our emotions and mood which manifest in the workplace as attitude
Anxiety	Distress or uneasiness of mind caused by fear of failure
Assessment	The act of assessing; appraisal; evaluation
Attendance	The persons or number of persons present
Attitude	Manner, feeling, position, with regard to a person or thing; tendency or orientation, especially of the mind
Autonomous	Independent, no control from others
Behaviour	Manner of acting in response to internal and external stimuli
Checklist	A list of items, as names or tasks, for comparison, verification, or other checking purposes
Clarify	To make clear, understood
Cognitive	Refers to the process of thought and our level of understanding of concepts
Comparing	To examine (two or more objects, ideas, people, etc.) in order to note similarities and differences
Competency	The demonstrated ability to consistently perform discrete tasks under specified conditions to an agreed standard
Counselling	Advice; opinion or instruction given in directing the judgment or conduct of another
Data	Pieces of information
Documents	A written or printed paper furnishing information or evidence
Enhancement	To rise to a higher level or understanding
Evidence	That which tends to prove or disprove something; ground for belief; proof
Feedback	Information, reaction or response to a particular process or activity

Term	Explanation
Format	The organisation, plan or style
Generic	General
Immediacy	Urgency, need to be done immediately
Knowledge	Understanding of facts, truths, or principles, as from study or investigation
Liaise	To talk and discuss
Literacy	Ability to read and write
Numeracy	Ability to calculate
Objective	Aim, end result
Performance	The execution or accomplishment of work, acts, feats, etc
Performance assessment	The activity of evaluating a person's performance
Performance appraisal	The act of estimating or judging a person's performance
Performance indicator	The expected level of desired performance
Policy	A rule or guideline of expected performance
Principles	An accepted or professed rule of action or conduct
Procedure	A specified step by step guide how an activity is to be conducted
Psychomotor	Refers to our ability to employ a skill to carry out a task
Sequencing	The logical order in which something is done
Skill	The ability to do something well
Standard	The desired level of performance
Task	An activity required to be completed
TNA	Training Needs Analysis

Element 1:

Plan a series of training events

1.1 Verify identified training need

Introduction

There is a growing awareness of the importance of training and developing people across a range of situations. Whilst a large range of training programs are made available by external training providers, circumstances often dictate that the bulk of an individual's training occurs on the job or as part of an internal group training process.

The need to be able to train people has increased in recent years, and many organisations now rely on their own trainers to ensure that staff are acquiring the skills and knowledge required to perform in their various work roles.



In order for training to be effective and ensure that individuals are receiving the skills and knowledge that they require, it is vitally important that the training itself is delivered in a way which ensures an efficient and lasting transfer of learning.

How many of us recall attending training presentations which on reflection seemed to be a waste of time. This may have been for any number of reasons. Perhaps the training was delivered in a boring way or the presentation was disorganised. Maybe the session was training you in something you already knew, or worse still, started way beyond your current level of understanding. In either case, the experience may have left you wondering why you even bothered attending.

This guide manual aims to assist you in planning, implementing and evaluating training events. It considers some of the foundation issues in putting together training which is well targeted and interesting and also considers your own personal presentation as an important part of the process. Great trainers are actually made through experience and an awareness of, and commitment to the true needs of the audience.

What are we trying to achieve through training?

In any training activity we are trying to bring about change in three main areas. Trainers refer to these as the **Psychomotor**, **Cognitive** and **Affective** areas.

Psychomotor refers to our ability to employ a skill to carry out a task. This may be slicing a loaf of bread or dealing with a customer complaint but in either case involves the practical application of skill.

Cognitive refers to the process of thought and our level of understanding of concepts. In order to carry out work functions we need to understand underlying principles, process information and apply knowledge.



Affective refers to our emotions and mood which manifest in the workplace as attitude. Attitude determines the way in which we deploy our knowledge and our skills. For example, someone who has a high level of skill in dealing with customer complaints and a deep knowledge of organisational policies and procedures may still give bad service if they don't care about what they are doing!

Identifying training needs

All training programs should go through this cycle to ensure effective outcomes.



Preparation for a training session begins long before any training takes place. In the first instance you must ask yourself what the need for the training actually is.

A great deal of time and money is spent in the workplace providing training for people who don't actually need it, whilst other needs go unaddressed. At a very simple level some thought should go into what training need is to be met through the training.

This may have already been done for you and you simply have to consider how to carry out the training, or you might have to conduct your own analysis of what is required.

A Training Needs Analysis (TNA) starts with a consideration of the skills and knowledge required for a particular job. This can then be contrasted with the skills and knowledge that a person already has. This will obviously be dependent upon your own knowledge of the jobs people are doing and are most likely to happen where you are arranging training for people with whom you work directly.

When you have determined the skill and knowledge gap between what people know and can do and what is actually required of them, you are in a position to consider the training requirement and what kind of activity might be required to meet this.

It is important to remember that training is not always a cure-all. There may be situations where such a gap is caused by poor supervision or unrealistic expectations of where a person should have progressed to in their work. Training should also be planned with an overall pathway of progress in mind.

Work based learning pathways enable people to go through training with the knowledge that there is an overall plan underlying the activity and that they are building a suite of skills and knowledge which will compliment their progress within the workplace. In order to be sure about the training we are delivering we need to identify the “gap”.

Training needs analysis

Training needs analysis process is a series of activities conducted to identify problems or other issues in the workplace and to determine whether training is an appropriate response.

The needs analysis is usually the first step taken to cause a change. This is mainly because a needs analysis specifically defines the gap between the current and the desired individual and organisational performances.

Who conducts needs analysis and why?

An in-house trainer or a consultant performs a needs analysis to collect and document information concerning any of the following three issues:

1. Performance problems
2. Anticipated introduction of new system, task or technology
3. A desire by the organisation to benefit from a perceived opportunity.



In all three situations, the starting point is a desire to effect a change. Given this, you must know how the people who will experience change perceive it. In the absence of a needs analysis, you may find employees resistant to change and reluctant to training. They may be unable to transfer their newly acquired skills to their jobs because of the organisational constraints.

A needs analysis often reveals the need for well-targeted training areas. However, we must keep in mind that training is not always the best way to try to close a particular gap between an organisation's goals and its actual performance. Those conducting the needs analysis must get a clear idea of the problem, look at all possible remedies and report on their findings to management before deciding on the best solution.

When properly done, a needs analysis is a wise investment for the organisation. It saves time, money and effort by working on the right problems. Organisations that fail to support needs analysis make costly mistakes; they use training when another method would have been more effective; they use too much or too little training, or they use training but fail to follow up on it. A well-performed analysis provides the information that can lead to solutions that focus on the areas of greatest need.

Process of conducting a training needs analysis is a systematic one based on specific information gathering techniques. Needs analysis proceeds in stages, with the findings of one stage affecting and helping to shape the next one. There is no easy or short-cut formula for carrying out this process.

Each particular situation requires its own mix of observing, probing, analysing and deducting.

In many ways, the needs analysis is like detective work; you follow up on every lead, check every piece of information and examine every alternative before drawing any solid conclusions. Only then you can ensure you have the evidence on which to base a sound strategy for problem solving.

Training Needs Analysis Form

The organisation now has a new training department and we want your input. We want to listen to what you have to say so we can develop a staff training program based on your needs. With our training we are looking to making our organisation an extremely professional, efficient and enjoyable place to work. This will reflect on our customers through satisfaction, happiness and positive feedback. Continual training, updating your industry knowledge and practicing new skills, or refining old ones, will ensure that we will achieve our goal. We would appreciate if you could answer the following questions honestly.

Please return this survey to your manager by the end of the week.

Name (optional): _____ Date: ____/____/____

Position: _____ Department: _____

How long have you worked for the organisation? _____

Please indicate your level of agreement with each of the following statements.		Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree
1.	The company values you	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
2.	I am proud to work for this organisation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
3.	There are clear goals for career progression at this company	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
4.	My job requirements are clean	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
5.	I am interested in my job	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
6.	I am motivated to see the company succeed	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
7.	Overall how satisfied are you with your current position at this company	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Answer yes or no to the following questions:					Yes	No
8.	Have you attended a staff induction?				☐	☐
9.	Did you receive and read a staff handbook?				☐	☐
10.	Would you like to see a staff rewards program?					
	Yes	How would you like to be rewarded? _____				
	No	Why not? _____				

11.	Would you like to progress within the company?	☐	☐
12.	Would you like to cross train by working in another department?	☐	☐
13.	Are you interested in completing a training qualification where you receive a nationally recognised certificate at no cost to you?	☐	☐
14.	Would training help you do your job better?	☐	☐

Please give us your opinion:

15. What training will help you with your current job?

16. What do you like best about your job?

17. What do you like least about your job?

18. What can we do to make your job better?

Is there anything else you would like to tell us?

Thank you for taking the time to complete this survey.

Once we have collected this survey we will be talking to staff to get further information. In the near future we will be letting you know more about what is on offer. We look forward to training and working with you.

Types of organisational staff

Training needs will differ with the backgrounds of the employees to be trained, and their present status in the organisation. Basically, a candidate for training may come from any one of three groups:

1. New hires
2. Veteran employees
3. Trainees currently in the training pipeline (currently in a training program).

Consideration of the varying needs of these groups provides a frame of reference for discussing and suggesting the methods of identifying training needs:

New hires

Addition of new employees creates high and low peaks in placing new persons into the training program. This problem may be solved by a program where progression is made in different sequences.

It will eliminate a jam that will occur if all phases of the program must be taken in a definite sequence.

The new employees will normally be of somewhat different backgrounds. Being new, they are not familiar with their new employers. As a result, the earliest phases of the training must concentrate on company orientation. During these phases, the organisation, organisation policies and administrative details should be covered. It is also a suitable time to acquaint the trainees with what will be expected of them, and how they will be evaluated throughout the phase of training.



Retaining and upgrading veteran employees

The people in this category offer a real challenge to the training department. Therefore, the number and amount of training required by this category should be carefully considered. Often the retraining and upgrading of former employees can be very rewarding for training instructors. At least two schools of thought exist as to how these employees should be rekindled. There are advantages in keeping this group intact and tailoring the program to their needs. On the other hand, this category of employees can also make significant contribution to training if they are co-mingled with the new hires.

Pipeline employee requirements

A good training program will normally have participants in various phases of completion. An awareness of completion dates and how the potential employee will be employed should be the concern of the training staff and also the employee's supervisor. A trainee should have a challenge in all phases of his training.

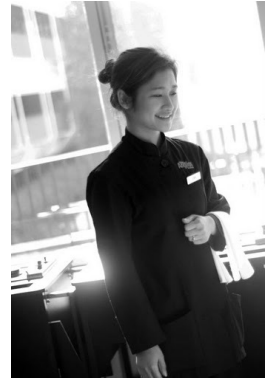
All these challenges should not be confined to those phases where the pipeline employee is sitting in a classroom. Therefore, it is recommended that thorough interim test work be given to pipeline employees in periods between formal classes. This may take the form of solidifying what they have learnt in the prior phase and serve as preparation for the coming phases.

Observations

In this approach, an employee's performance itself is your source of information. You evaluate a worker's performance through first-hand observation and analysis. This is best accomplished by watching the worker and playing the role of non-participating observer. This means that you watch and listen and evaluate what you see and hear, but do not get involved in their work process in any way.

To make this activity more productive, use a checklist to remind you of what to look for and take notes.

The objective during observations is to identify both the strengths to build on and the deficiencies to overcome. A key advantage of using direct observation in the needs analysis is that you gain first-hand knowledge and understanding of the job being performed and the strengths and weaknesses of the relevant worker.



Interviews

The use of interviews in conducting the needs analysis is strongly recommended. The prime value of interview guides is that they ensure the same types of data from all sources. This allows you to determine whether a piece of information is one person's opinion, or part of a widespread perception.

Since the interview guide forces you to ask each worker a number of predetermined questions, you must select those questions that are essential to what you are trying to learn.

Interviews allow you to meet employees face to face to discuss their impressions of performance.

Because you are in conversation with workers, you can explore their responses in depth. You can ask for clarification of comments and for examples of what they mean. In this way, you obtain a full understanding of their performance deficiencies.



Benefits through interviewing

- You build credibility with your interviewees by asking intelligent questions and listening well to their answers
- You obtain employees' personal involvement and commitment to your efforts
- You establish personal relationships with potential trainees who are important to your success as a needs analyst and trainer.

Questionnaires

A questionnaire is a sort of interview on paper. You create your own questionnaire by writing down all the questions you want employees to answer for you. Then give it to them and await their responses.

The key advantage of a questionnaire is that you can include every person from whom you want input.

Employees can complete the questionnaire when and where they choose. You need not travel and spend time with all respondents. Every employee is asked identical questions and consequently data is very easy to compile and analyse.

Questionnaires can be useful in obtaining a 'big picture' of what a large number of employees think while allowing everyone to feel that they have had an opportunity to participate in the needs analysis process.



Job descriptions

Before establishing a job description, a job analysis must be made. This job analysis involves a thorough study of all responsibilities of the relevant job. It is companywide in scope and should be detailed to such a degree that those conducting the training can use the job analysis as a yardstick for their course content. After the job analysis phase has been completed, the writing of job description and needs analysis is a relatively simple task. When an employee's job description has been defined, the trainer can easily tailor his training curriculum to a very close proximity of what will be expected of the employees.

The difficulty analysis

The Job Analysis will focus attention on enumerating the numerous duties that a worker must perform.

On the other hand, the Difficulty Analysis establishes which of the duties cause the employee the greatest amount of problems and how these problems can be reduced through better training.

Advantages of a Difficulty Analysis

- It enables a needs analyst to weigh certain aspects of the training in relationship to the expected difficulty that the worker will face in coping with those duties
- A well thought out Difficulty Analysis will provide the training program with an abundance of role playing material and situations.

Problem solving conferences

Another time-tested technique for gathering needs analysis material from employees is to conduct periodic problem solving conferences which may take the form of or be part of a plan for a new product, task or technology, or tied in with a training program. It is always helpful to utilise an outside consultant to moderate such sessions. This outside sponsorship has a tendency of letting the workers express their feelings about their organisation and the session can then be geared to training needs. The current problems will evolve that represent potential areas for training.



Appraisal reviews

During the periodic counselling performance interview, an employee should be questioned regarding the duties and training of a worker. Comments rendered during the appraisal interviews normally are genuine, and can frequently assist in establishing the needs, variations and penetrations that a training program should include. Feed- back at appraisal interview time is valuable since it is timely information.

Training needs differ from worker to worker and appraisal sessions allow the employee and supervisor / manager to uncover the cause of weaknesses in performance. These deficiencies represent areas for training.



Drive pattern identity

The extent of an employee's development depends on their motivations. Identifying the forces that cause an employee to behave in a certain way may be useful in determining their individual training needs and how to stimulate their desire to fulfil that need. An analysis of this kind, for example, may determine that the employee has an urgent need for self-confidence. Their individual program should be made to stress the importance of attitude, skills etc. and any other assets that would give him this self- confidence.

Organisational policy

Organisation policy will affect the amount of training offered. An explanation of various policies should be covered in the training program. Of particular concern are those policies that involve change, alteration and major revamping of training programs. In organisations undergoing merger activity, product diversification and new penetration, a great deal of sensitivity must be placed on policies today and expected changes in the future.

Overview of identifying training needs

Whatever the method used to identify training needs, at least the following three points must be kept in view:

- These methods should be used in combination. That is, there should never be reliance on only one method
- They may be used to identify training needs of each of the various groups of employees
- They should be applied to individual employees since training needs will vary with the individual employee.

Verify identified training needs

It is important that training needs of an individual or a group as a whole have not only been identified but are confirmed as true and accurate.

To date, this section has explored a number of ways in which to identify training needs.

There are also a number of ways to verify training needs. These include:

- Reviewing the results of training needs analyses
- Reviewing individual input, including requests for training, from staff, co-workers, customers, supervisors, managers and other relevant personnel
- Reviewing business plans, directions and objectives
- Reviewing existing qualifications, certificates, licenses, etc held by staff
- Reviewing changed workplace conditions necessitating staff training, including changes to equipment, procedures, legislation, layout, customer preferences etc
- Clarifying training requirements by site, department, individual worker, workplace teams.

It is essential that the training needs are correct. If not, the whole process of planning and implementing training will not be effective in improving the performance of staff and the organisation as a whole.

Verifying training needs with relevant personnel

As part of the training needs verification process, this may involve discussion with relevant personnel within the organisation. Development of training programs take time and it is important that information is verified, or suggestions for improvement made, before too much time is spent developing a program that is not relevant, inappropriate or simply not required.

Relevant personnel

The role of training normally falls under a specific training department or within the domain of Human Resources. This department is designed to support operational departments (Food and Beverage, Front Office and Housekeeping etc) achieve their goals in providing quality customer service, operational efficiency and financial success.

Human Resources

The Human Resources department themselves will have a limited amount of resources in which to conduct training for the entire organisation and therefore training programs must be prioritised in terms of:

- Training budget
- Priority of training programs
- Training staff
- Availability of training rooms and resources.



Operational Managers

Whilst training may be the responsibility of the training department to organise, prepare or conduct, the objectives of the programs and training delivered must reflect the expectations of the operational departments.

Therefore it is vital that once the training needs have been identified, that they are confirmed with managers of specific departments to ensure they agree with the findings and are happy for the training department to proceed with developing training programs based on these.

1.2 Prioritise identified training need

Introduction

Once all the training needs have been identified and confirmed it is important that the most urgent and pressing training needs are addressed first.

This is the process of prioritisation.

But how can you determine which training needs require immediate action or importance over others.

This section will explore methods to use when prioritising identified training needs.



Matching training need against workplace demands

It is important to identify which needs are required in which area. This may be categorised by:

- Site
- Department
- Workplace teams
- Individual worker.

Naturally the identified needs that affect the most people will be a main priority for staff, as opposed to skills required for just one individual.

In addition, skills required by staff with direct contact with customers may also be deemed more important than those required by staff in support roles.

Factoring in legislated obligations

Naturally any new or amended law requiring staff to have specific skill sets, licenses or certification will need to be addressed immediately.

Some of these training areas may include, but certainly not limited to:

- Health and Safety
- Emergency procedures and evacuation
- First Aid
- Food Handling
- Responsible Service of Alcohol
- Manual handling
- Specific software programs
- Gaming.

In many cases, these programs will be compulsory for all staff or those in specific roles or departments. Staff may be required to attend public programs or have expert trainers conduct these in the workplace.

Determining existing competency levels to cater for anticipated demand

It is essential that staff have the right 'competencies' to meet the requirements of the workplace.

Competency

Competence is the demonstrated ability to consistently perform discrete tasks under specified conditions to an agreed standard.

Competency comprises knowledge and skills and the consistent application of that knowledge and skills to the standard of performance required in employment.

Competency can be defined as the ability to do something. In order to do something a person will require a combination of three things:

- Knowledge – called the cognitive domain. These are the 'head' skills such as what people think and their level of knowledge
- Skill – called the psychomotor domain. These are the 'hand' skills such as what people can do
- Attitude – called the affective domain. These are the 'heart' skills such as what people feel.



Training is a key to being able to develop the competencies of staff.

Every organisation will have dedicated training programs aimed at ensuring all staff are able to develop their competency levels to meet the desired standards.

Lots of on-the-job training will be skill-related, but nearly every training event has a need to include coverage of the attitude and knowledge areas, too.

In the hospitality industry where customer interaction and service is vital, it is not enough to be able to perform a practical task. It is equally important to be able to accompany the skill with the right interpersonal skills that are all attitude-based.

Identifying current competencies of learners

Before staff will be called upon to undertake training, a manager must identify if a learning need exists.

This involves understanding:

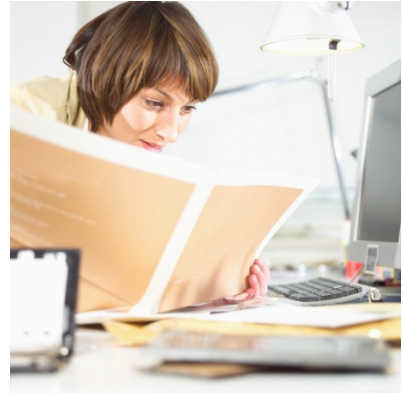
- Current competencies of learners
- Comparing them against expected competency standards.

The ways in which you can capture the necessary information about competencies of learners include:

Review their personnel file

One way of identifying competencies of learners is to review background information about each learner. Information contained in their personnel file will provide sound background information including:

- Resume – their resume will give a ‘snapshot’ of what they have achieved in their professional life to date and is a great starting point in understanding a learner
- Current qualifications - check to see the qualifications they hold, how long ago they were obtained and where they were obtained
- Training programs completed - check their attendance at current training and look at the progress they have made with other in-house training situations
- Length of employment – the longer the person has been employed, normally will lead to the assumption that they have higher competency levels
- Structure of employment – what is their job role, have they changed jobs, have they had exposure to multi-skilling
- Awards and comments – the file may contain guest comment cards either positive or negative, managers may have constructed comments or awards may have been issued
- Performance appraisal information – this document provides extensive and detailed information relating to the current competency levels of a learner in all aspects of their job.



Talk to people

Talking to people is a great way to get current information regarding the competency levels of a learner. Some documents located in the learner file may be outdated or not descriptive enough to identify true competency, therefore speaking with others will also help answer any remaining questions. People to talk to include:

- Talk to the learner – ask them about their training history, their preferences and their attitude to learning in the workplace: find out what, if any, obstacles stand in the way of their workplace learning (factors such as family commitments, sport and other learning activities)
- Speak to other trainers – What can they tell you about the learners? Based on their experiences, where are possible strengths and weaknesses?
- Speak to other supervisors who have delivered training – what information can they give you about what seems to work and not work with certain staff, in their experience.

Observation

One of the most effective ways to determine and understand a learner’s competency level is to observe what the learner is able to do.

This may be done by the trainer or another suitable person.

Trainer collecting competency evidence

This is most common form of conducting the observation and collection of evidence.

The trainer may wish to notify the learner or may wish to do it without their knowledge to gather a true understanding of competency.

The trainer may use a checklist or other documents to help identify current competency levels.

Others collecting competency evidence

If the observation was conducted by another person, the trainer will need to collect any documents, checklists and any other supporting evidence that comprises the observation.

They may wish to let the person know in advance of when the documentation will be required.

This information collection process may also include a brief meeting to verbally exchange information or comments not suitable for inclusion in written documentation.

Assessments

A trainer may wish to give a learner a range of assessment tasks to identify their current competency levels. These assessments may include:

- Written or verbal questions
- Demonstration
- Project or assignment
- Portfolio of work.



Once the true competency of learners has been identified, trainers must now identify the required competencies required by learners.

Identifying expected competency standards

Workplace training and assessment is competency-based. This means successful completion of training requires the learners to be able to demonstrate competency in the areas in which they are being trained.

As a trainer, you need to know what these competencies are. The competencies to be achieved must be driven by the workplace process and context. This means that you train learners to be able to do the job as required in your workplace.

These competencies may be available in written form within your business but, in many cases, there are no written competencies. These workplace competencies simply exist in practice only and it will be part of your job to produce them in hard copy form.

These standards may come from:

- Job descriptions
- Job Specifications
- Key Performance Indicators
- Policies and Procedures
- Performance Indicators.

Determining costs associated with immediate and short-term training events to respond to urgent training needs

Each training activity will have respective costs. These costs may include, but are not limited to:

- Cost of training facility and materials
- Transport
- Accommodation
- Meals
- Cost of trainer
- Cost of participants to attend
- Salaries of participants whilst in training
- Salaries of replacement staff.



It is not hard to see that these costs can be quite considerable when large numbers of participants will need to undertake training.

This does not also take into account any further disruptions this may have on normal operations.

When deciding on training, the benefits of training must be weighed against the costs.

Identifying the impact of not responding immediately to urgent need

If an establishment is deciding whether to participate in a training event it is vital that they consider the likely impacts non involvement may have on the organisation.

These include:

- Closure of operations due to non-compliance with legal requirements
- Fines
- Level and severity of customer complaints
- Costs associated with handling or compensating customer complaints
- Loss of business
- Loss of productivity.

Identifying other priority activities that the organisation is required to accommodate

In many cases, a hospitality business may consider not decide to partake in training activities for a number of reasons including:

- Budget restrictions – see below
- Organisational policy
- Head Office directives
- Significant costs of training

- No training venues available
- High occupancy and operational demands, including servicing VIPs
- Inability to find suitable programs or trainers
- Inability to find replacement staff to cover shifts whilst others are in training
- Unclear of the training benefits.

Budget restrictions

Every business in every industry has budget restraints in which they must operate. The hospitality industry is no different.

Each department will have a fixed budget for various activities.

Organisations may have a budget priority towards expenditure in other operational areas including:

- Refurbishments
- Upgrading of room amenities
- Purchase of furniture, fixtures and fittings
- Purchase of hardware and software.

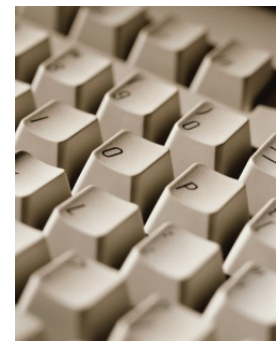


Identifying alternative short-term action, other than training events, that can be taken to address immediate priority needs

Some organisations may seek to explore different possible solutions to overcome problems associated with lack of training.

Some of these activities may include:

- Implement technology (hardware and software) to alleviate human deficiencies
- Employ experienced staff, whether on a short term or permanent basis
- Change operational procedures
- Close areas or restrict services associated with high operational problems.



1.3 Determine resources available to support training events to address identified training need

Introduction

Once the need for training has been identified and agreed upon for action, it is now time to determine the resources that will be required to successfully plan and implement the events associated with each training activity.

Whilst every training event is unique, comprising of different durations, topics and methods of delivery there are still a number of common resource factors that must be taken into consideration.



When planning a training program for a hotel, it is important to remember that there will be a complex mix of training to be conducted comprising different:

- Competencies
- Dimensions of competencies
- Training styles
- Equipment and resources
- Locations.

One training person cannot and is not expected to undertake all training by themselves. At some stage support will be needed, across resources within and external to the organisation.

It is important for a trainer to determine early in the planning process at what levels and to what degree they need the support and assistance of others.

Time

The first consideration will normally be time. Timing considerations include:

- Duration of the training program
- Breakdown of components within the program
- Days of the week to deliver
- Times of the day to deliver
- Availability of venues, trainers and participants
- When is the most suitable time for participants to undertake training whilst having minimal impact on operations.



Space, location and venues

Training may take place within the establishment itself or may require participants to journey to a tailor made training facility or program.

If training is to be arranged and conducted internally there are some considerations that will impact on the most suitable venue:

- Number of participants
- Use of main rooms and breakout rooms
- Style of training event - see next section
- Intended content of training
- Level of practical involvement and practice.



Human resources

Trainer competency

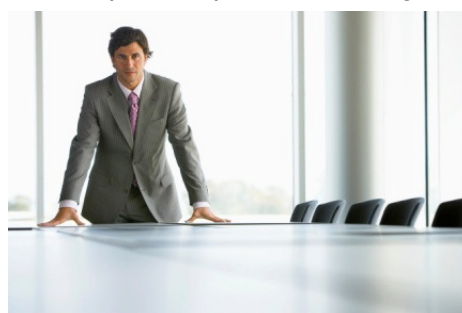
If a trainer is considering delivering instruction and demonstrations to staff, they have to be able to do it competently.

They have to be absolutely sure that training to be done reflects workplace needs and practice. Their techniques and knowledge have to be absolutely spot on.

Their inability to deliver training comprehensively and correctly at all times, will negatively impact on the effectiveness of the training and destroy their workplace reputation amongst staff.

Most training professionals may have the necessary training skills to deliver a program, but may be weak in the operational and technical content within the training programs themselves.

Therefore, if they believe their competencies are not what they should be, they really only have two options:



- Arrange for some training for themselves so that you can get up-to-speed with what is required
- Get someone else to provide the training for staff.

Seeking human resources support

In reality there will be a distinct possibility that any trainer will need assistance to deliver some workplace training.

When this occurs, it is important they understand this does not negatively reflect on their competence or ability. As stated, no-one can ever know everything and no-one is capable of training all staff in everything they need to know.

When they identify a situation where assistance is required – they need to get it!

If a trainer identifies a situation where they need help and fail to obtain it, then that indicates their incompetence!

Assistance can come in many forms, so trainers must be alert to what best suits each set of circumstances as they arise.

Location of human resources support

Support may come from other people:

- Inside the organisation including Human Resources and training personnel, managers, supervisors or senior staff
- Outside the organisation including professional trainers, equipment suppliers or specialist personnel such as medical practitioners.

Types of human resources support

A trainer may wish to seek support in a variety of ways including:

- Contacting an expert to obtain their verbal input to the upcoming training. They might ask them to identify what needs to be delivered, get them to clarify recent legal changes that apply to their area, ask them to provide you with workplace illustrations of various aspects of the training. This expert can be a worker from within the organisation, an outside consultant, a government official or someone from head office, an industry body or a support industry
- Arranging for someone else to deliver the training – this can be another in-house staff member (the 'subject expert', a previous learner who has proved themselves to be extremely competent, or a supervisor), or it can be a professional trainer from an external training provider. It may also be someone from a supplier organisation. For example, if you have had new equipment installed in the store, the best person to provide the training might be a trainer from the business who supplied the equipment
- Arranging for guest speakers – to come in and supplement the basic training you deliver
- Arranging external events – such as taking learners on a field trip to another business, a supplier, or an industry conference or seminar
- Obtaining training materials that someone else has prepared.

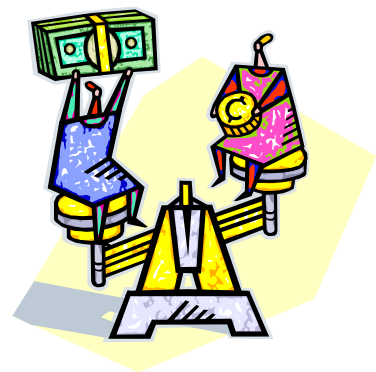


Financial resources

As mentioned in the previous section, there are a number of financial considerations that must be considered.

The main considerations are:

- Cost of training
- Budget allocated to training.



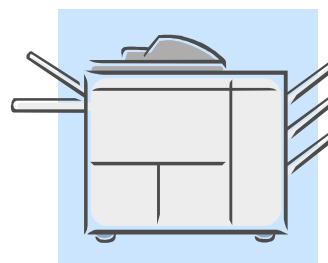
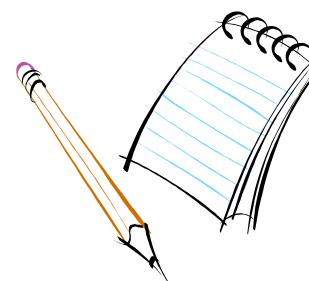
Physical resources

Learning resources and materials

To be clear, learning resources and learning materials are the same thing. Essentially, we are talking here about anything you need to use to provide or support training delivery.

Examples of learning resources include:

- Notes, manuals, handouts, PowerPoint presentations, posters, copies of price lists, supplier catalogues, forms used within the business, organisational policy and procedure manuals, reference material and texts, record/log books, tapes and disks
- Items required to support training practice – these may be case studies, activities, exercises, written tests, worksheets and workbooks, task sheets and practical exercises that you require learners to perform
- Samples of items or finished products – used to illustrate what is required, to demonstrate a point or to show learners what options are available
- Equipment used for demonstrations – including all associated items, utensils and ancillary material (for example, if you were training staff on how to use a cash register the audit roll for the register would be ancillary material. If you were training someone on how to use a computer, then a portable data stick/disk would probably be needed for them to save their material)
- Consumables – anything that is used during the training process is a consumable: for example, if you were training staff in how to make a cappuccino, then the coffee, sugar, milk, etc. would be consumables. Even the whiteboard markers, paper for printing and toner for the photocopy machine and printer are regarded as consumables
- Multimedia tools.



Effective use of multimedia tools

All trainers can benefit from the use of multimedia tools.

Types of multimedia tools

There are many multimedia tools that can be used effectively to help facilitate learning including:

- DVDs – there are endless subject topics
- TV shows – including documentaries and specialist subject programs which are great visual and informative tools
- Video conference calls – this enables specialists and senior management to be an active part of the training session, regardless of geographical location
- Internet – there are various websites including *You Tube* that can provide information or be used as an effective research tool.



Benefits of using multimedia

There are many benefits of using multimedia including:

- Adds a different form of training which can bring variety to the overall program
- Helps reinforce points presented by trainer
- Can be used as a primary source of information by a respected source or person
- Can be used as a secondary source of information, in which case studies can be based around it
- Provides real life examples and stories in a visually stimulating format
- Eases pressure on trainers having to 'talk' all the time
- Serves as a backup training aid to fill times where scheduled training runs ahead of schedule.

Sources of learning resources and materials

While this manual suggests that your role will simply be to use existing learning resources and materials, the reality is often much different, requiring you to:

- Use existing resources
- Generate them yourself
- Purchasing them from professional training organisations
- Obtain them from other sources.

Using existing resources and materials

Using existing resources, where available, is the most effective way of preparing resources as a lot of the hard work has already been done.

In most cases, they will need to be altered to meet the exact needs of the training programs in mind.

It is vital that all existing resources are checked before they are used to make sure they reflect the training objectives that they will be used to support.

In addition, by reviewing the information, it ensures that all relevant material is included and also serves as a refresher on the information provided within.

The biggest problem with learning resources is that they get out-of-date very quickly.

Remember that your training must reflect actual workplace practice, and by the same token, the learning materials must support that specific training delivery. For example, you may have a whole range of excellent learning resources to use when training new staff in the operation of the cash register, but if the type of cash register used today is different from what was used last year, all those magnificent learning resources will be useless.

You simply can't use anything that is out-of-date or which fails to support the identified training objectives.

You also need to check there are no errors in the material. This includes not only procedural mistakes such as printed notes that actually present the wrong way to do something, but also checks for spelling errors and typos.

It should be standard practice for trainers to review their notes after every use in order to rectify these types of mistakes. A trainer who continues to use materials that contain mistakes is just lazy.

If the check on the existing learning materials reveals they are deficient in any way, you must take appropriate action to address that situation. This can mean a simple rewrite of notes through to buying in externally prepared materials.

It is also important to check any copyright or use restrictions on materials or resources to be used.

As a trainer, you may also wish to supplement these existing notes, with your own additional materials as required.

Use workplace materials and resources wherever possible

Using materials available from within the workplace is the best training option because:

- It reflects and accommodates current workplace practice
- It is often more readily available
- It can be much cheaper than other bought-in alternatives.

For example, if you were conducting a training session that focussed on arithmetical skills, it would be very appropriate to use a workplace price list and order form, as well as perhaps a workplace invoice, statement, or credit note for the examples and exercises.



The use of workplace documentation (in this example) lends a workplace context to what is otherwise a very generic skill – and this workplace orientation should motivate learners and add depth and application to their learning.

If you are using workplace documents, you must ensure you know all about any forms, that you are going to use.

For example, make sure you know:

- When it has to be completed
- Who has to complete it
- What details are required in the form
- Where the form is available
- Where it goes once it is completed
- What all the sections of the form are used for
- Whether or not authorisation for the document is required – and if so, from whom and how that authorisation is recorded.

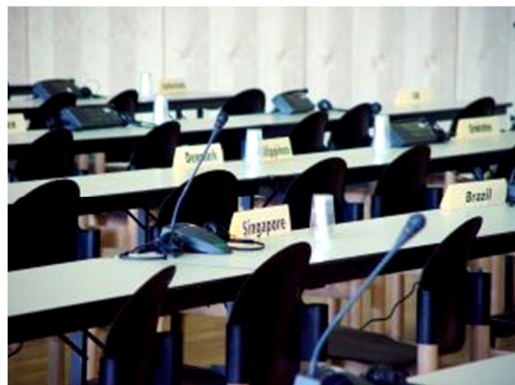
Externally available training events

This section has explored a range of resource considerations when considering running an internal training program.

In many cases, it may be easier to enrol participants into external programs that may already be running.

These can include:

- Corporate events – including food and wine festivals etc
- Seminars and lectures
- Working groups
- Industry association events
- Exhibitions
- Public short courses – whether open to the general public or tailored programs for an individual property or group, however delivered in a specific training centre or location
- Qualification programs – Certificate, Diploma and Degree qualifications
- Organisational wide programs – in large hospitality chains, Head Office may arrange a series of training programs in central locations enabling individual properties to send staff to.



1.4 Identify training events that will address identified workplace training need

Introduction

Training of staff is a primary requirement for all business development. As the direct provider of services to customers, customers must not only have the knowledge and skills to be able to do their job adequately, they must also have support and guidance from management.

Normally training events are arranged when:

- Customer service deficiencies exist which need to be addressed
- New staff require training
- New techniques to existing products or services are made
- New products or services are introduced
- Retraining is required.



Whilst training events should take place for traditional reasons that are mentioned above, it should be an ongoing activity that involves greater support, and encouragement and coaching.

In choosing training events, trainers should take into account the practical, complex and multi-disciplinary nature of the subject area, as well as their participant's prior knowledge, learning styles and abilities.

Types of training events

Whilst training events traditionally are focused towards formal training, in essence can be classified as any activity that enables staff to improve their service delivery. Many of these activities have been identified in the previous section however the list of activities that management can do is varied.

Training events include any activity that will result in learner attainment of/or progress towards identified workplace attitudes, skills and/or knowledge.

Following is a brief explanation of common training events:

Lecture, Tutorial

This is a common method of training involving transfer of information from the trainer to the participants. It is an effective approach to introduce new concepts or information to the learners and also to build upon the existing knowledge. The listener is expected to reflect on the subject and seek clarifications on the doubts.



Demonstration

Demonstration is a very effective training method that involves a trainer showing a participant how to perform a task or activity. Through a visual demonstration, trainers may also explain reasoning behind certain actions or provide supplementary information to help facilitate understanding.



Group Discussions

Brain storming in which all the members in a group expresses their ideas, views and opinion on a given topic, It is a free flow and exchange of knowledge among the participants and the trainer. The discussion is carried out by the group on the basis of their own experience, perceptions and values. This will facilitate acquiring new knowledge. When everybody is expected to participate in the group discussion, even the introvert persons will also get stimulated and try to articulate their feelings.

The ideas that emerged in the discussions should be noted down and presentations are to be made by the groups. Sometimes consensus needs to be arrived on a given topic. Group discussions are to be held under the moderation of a leader guided by the trainer. Group discussion technique, triggers thinking process, encourages interactions and enhances communication skills.

Role Play

This is a common and very effective method of bringing into the classroom real life situations, which may not otherwise be possible. Participants are made to enact a particular role so as to give a real feel of the roles they may be called upon to play. This enables participants to understand the behaviour of others as well as their own emotions and feelings. The instructor must brief the role players on what is expected of them. The role player may either be given a ready-made script, which they can memorise and enact, or they may be required to develop their own scripts around a given situation, thus making the role play more extemporaneous. This technique is extremely useful in understanding creative selling techniques and human relations. It can be entertaining and energising and it helps the reserved and less literate to express their feelings.

Simulation Games

When trainees need to become aware of something that they have not been conscious of, simulations can be a useful mechanism. Simulation games are a method based on "here and now" experience shared by all the participants. The games focus on the participation of the trainees and their willingness to share their ideas with others. Here, a "near real life" situation is created providing an opportunity to which they apply themselves by adopting certain behaviour. They then experience the impact of their behaviour on the situation. It is carried out to generate responses and reactions based on the real feelings of the participants, which are subsequently analysed by the trainer.

While use of simulation games can result in very effective learning, it needs considerable trainer competence to analyse the situations.

Individual or Group Exercises

Exercises are often introduced to find out how much the participant has assimilated. This method involves imparting instructions to participants on a particular subject through use of written exercises. In the group exercises, the entire class is divided into small groups, and members are asked to collaborate to arrive at a consensus or solution to a problem.

Case Study

This is a training method, which enables the trainer and the participant to experience a real life situation. It may be on account of events in the past or situations in the present, in which there may be one or more problems to be solved and decisions to be taken. The basic objective of a case study is to help participants diagnose, analyse and/or solve particular problem and to make them to internalise the critical inputs delivered in the training. Questions are generally given at the end of the case study to direct the participants and to stimulate their thinking towards possible solutions. Studies may be presented in written or verbal form.

Field Visit

This includes field trips, experiential learning, visits to nominated businesses, sites or venues or guest speakers.

This involves a carefully planned visit or tour to a place of learning or interest. The idea is to give first-hand knowledge by personal observation of field situations, and to relate theory with practice. The emphasis is on observing, exploring, asking questions and understanding. The trainer should remember to brief the participants about what they should observe and about the customs and norms that need to be respected.



Group Presentation

The participants are asked to work in groups and produce the results and findings of their group work to the members of other sub group. By this method participants get a good picture of each other's views perceptions on the topic and they are able to compare them with their own point of view. The pooling and sharing of findings enriches the discussion and learning process.

Practice Sessions

This method is of paramount importance for skill training. Participants are provided with an opportunity to practice, in controlled situation what they have learnt (that which they may have acquired through methods). It could be real life or through make-believe situation.

Games

This is a group process and includes those methods that involve usually fun-based activity, aimed at conveying feelings and experiences, which are everyday in nature, and applying them within the game being played. A game has set rules and regulations, and may or may not include a competitive element. After the game is played, it is essential that the participants be debriefed and their lessons and experiences consolidated by the trainer.

Research Activities

Trainers may require learners to undertake research activities, including online research, to gather information or further understanding about a specific subject area.

Qualifications and certified training programs

These are formal and informal learning opportunities relevant to identified need.

They are commonly provided by external educational or professional providers. Their duration varies depending on the qualification.

This also includes generic training courses, including a series of training events, offered by external training providers.

Specialised programs

This is training provided by suppliers, support industries, industry peak bodies and/or government.

On the job learning

This is where participants develop their knowledge, skill and attitudes in the normal course of undertaking their role and associated duties. As their experience increases, normally their understanding also increases.

Buddy system

This is where a participant works in close proximity with another, normally more experienced, work colleague, and learns through observation, discussions, guidance and feedback.

Home study

This is where a participant is able to gather knowledge and skills at home, using a variety of different learning activities including practice, reading of journals and other publications, through to internet research.

Other events

The list of training events is endless, but includes:

- Conferences
- Seminars
- Meetings
- Exhibitions
- Trade presentations
- Symposiums
- Agencies.



1.5 Determine availability of learners to attend and participate in identified training events

Introduction

There is often the belief training events 'just happen'.

The reality is effective training must be planned, organised and arranged.

Training events not properly planned tend to confuse the learner and embarrass the trainers themselves.

This is especially true when it comes to timing of training events. It is no point scheduling training activities if no one is able to turn up.

One of the key considerations when arranging training events is to ensure that it can be done at a time that suits not only trainers, but more importantly the learners themselves.

Given that a hospitality organisation is a never closing 24 hour concern, trying to find suitable training times that can accommodate the greatest number of staff is a challenge in itself.

In many organisations there are a number of considerations that must be taken into account when selecting appropriate times.

This section will explore some of these.



Identify suitable times



One of the main activities when determining suitable times is interrogating existing staff rosters to identify flexibility available to accommodate staff absences and attendance at training events.

As each department requires certain levels of staffing to ensure the smooth delivery of operations, not only is it important to pick a time when staff are free to attend, but to ensure that replacement staff can be found to cover

their place, with no reduction in service standards.

In optimal cases, training may take place when the department is closed, such as conducting training for bar staff in the morning, or between meal periods in the restaurant.

Unfortunately in many departments there are no designated 'closed periods'.

In these cases, some departments may run two times for training, one in the morning and one in the afternoon to enable different staff members to attend.

Liaise with supervisors

Liaising with supervisors to identify alternative staff to back-fill those attending training events is essential.

As mentioned in many cases training will need to take place when normal operations are still being conducted.

Replacement staff may come from external sources such as through recruitment agencies, however due to the short time periods required for replacement staff, in many cases staff will be drawn from other departments.

Therefore discussions between managers and supervisors from different departments are critical in identifying suitable times when staff can be released to other departments.

In large hospitality chains, managers of different hotels may 'exchange' staff to backfill staff shortages due to training.



This can be a 'win-win' in situations where one hotel is quiet and looking for ways to keep permanent staff busy. This is a regular situation that affects hotels with seasonal trade, such as beach resorts etc.

Liaise with finance department

Liaising with the financial department to calculate staffing costs associated with attendance at training events is also an important point requiring consideration.

Different establishments will have different policies relating to the timing of delivery of training sessions.

A central issue relates to paying staff to attend training. This greatly affects scheduling of training events.

Some organisations will wish to conduct training during scheduled work times as to not add additional labour costs and make staff come to work for greater periods of time.

Some employers are happy to pay staff to attend training, and others prefer not to do so.

A variation to this is where the employer may be prepared to pay, say, for 2 hours of training but the staff member is expected to contribute the rest of the time needed 'free of charge at their own expense and in their own time without being paid).

It can obviously be much more difficult to arrange training sessions for staff who are not being paid to attend.

Identifying peak and low trading times, days and periods

Every department will have traditionally busy times in which training cannot or should be conducted. In most organisations training is undertaken during quiet times, where great numbers of staff are not required to meet operational needs.

Identify participant's time restrictions and personal affairs

As mentioned, organisers of training events must strive to match the delivery of training programs with the ability of staff to attend.

This means factoring in the work demands of staff together with their out of work obligations such as their family, sporting commitments, community service obligations and socialising requirements.

It is often frustrating to have to arrange training events around such restrictions, but it is part of training life. Arranging a suitable time for training seems to be a continual juggling act trying to get times when both you and the persons being trained are available and willing to participate.



Sometimes training may occur during working hours and sometimes it may need to occur before or after work.

Identify productive times

In many cases, the only time to get all staff together to conduct training may be at times outside normal work hours or when operations may be quiet. These times may be early in the morning or late in the afternoon.

Just because times for training may have been identified it is important to ensure that any training conducted at that time will be 'productive'. For example, if staff are worked all day, they may be too tired to actively participate in training after hours.

Consider additional time required outside of training hours

Just because training may take place within designated hours, this does not mean that participants are not required to dedicated time outside of structured training hours for other activities such as:

- Necessary study
- Practice
- Research activities
- Assessments as appropriate to individual training events.



1.6 Involve stakeholders in planning activities

Introduction

Training should be designed to get the greatest benefit to participants and the organisation as a whole. It is therefore important that these stakeholders are an active part of the planning process.

It is essential that organisational management, trainers and the participants themselves not only understand what training events are taking place, but seek the value in it and take an active role in ensuring its success.

Types of stakeholders

There are a number of possible stakeholders who may be associated with training events.

These may include:

- Learners
- Human Resources
- Training Department
- Department heads
- Organisation
- Industry experts
- Trainers
- Administration staff.



Discussing training event options with supervisors, managers and learners

It is important that all stakeholders have the opportunity to discuss and decide upon which training activities will have the greatest benefit for all concerned.

Whilst it is not possible to satisfy everyone, it is important to try to please the majority of stakeholders.

Involving the participants

Discuss program with learners

It is important for the individuals being trained to be involved in the development of their training plan. This helps them to understand coaching is being created to suit their needs and to help bring their workplace performance in line with expectations.

Their involvement in the planning phase will:

- Demonstrate your intention to assist them as an individual. This discussion shows the investment the business is prepared to make in them
- Prove they are a valuable asset to the organisation even though they may not be 100% competent. This should help allay any fears they may have about losing their job just because they cannot do things, or they do not know things
- Allow them to share any additional training needs they have. Many staff have 'hidden' training needs they are reluctant to share, fearing job loss, reduced hours or less chance of promotion
- Enable you to get to know them better as an individual. This includes finding out about their previous training experiences, identifying restrictions they have on their participation in coaching, talking about their previous work history/experience and their out of work interests.



Your discussion with the learner should also:

- Explain why the training is needed
- Highlight the benefits of receiving training to the learner, the business and to the customers
- Obtain agreement coaching is a legitimate activity in the particular context and can be seen as a way of achieving mutually acceptable results
- Agree to outcomes for the training.

Creating participant centered learning

As mentioned, the whole purpose of training is to ensure that learners have the ability to improve any aspect of knowledge, skills or attitudes. It is therefore important to ensure that any training events are centred around the participants themselves.

This involves taking into account structuring training and assessment that:

- *Building on strengths* – Training environments need to demonstrate the many positive features of local participants (such as the attribution of academic success to effort, and the social nature of achievement motivation) and of their trainers (such as a strong emphasis on subject disciplines and moral responsibility). These strengths and uniqueness of local participants and trainers should be acknowledged and treasured
- *Acknowledging prior knowledge and experience* - The learning activities should be planned with participants prior knowledge and experience in mind
- *Understanding learning objectives* - Each learning activity should have clear learning objectives and participants should be informed of them at the outset. Trainers should

also be clear about the purpose of assignments and explain their significance to participants

- *Teaching for understanding* - The pedagogies chosen should aim at enabling participants to act and think flexibly with what they know
- *Teaching for independent learning* - Generic skills and reflection should be nurtured through learning activities in appropriate contexts of the curriculum. Participants should be encouraged to take responsibility for their own learning
- *Enhancing motivation* - Learning is most effective when participants are motivated. Various strategies should be used to arouse the interest of participants
- *Effective use of resources* - A variety of teaching resources can be employed as tools for learning
- *Maximising engagement* - In conducting learning activities, it is important for the minds of participants to be actively engaged
- *Aligning assessment with learning and teaching* - Feedback and assessment should be an integral part of learning and teaching
- *Catering for learner diversity* - Trainers should be aware that participants have different characteristics and strengths and try to nurture these rather than impose a standard set.

Establish 'active learning'

The goal of nurturing independent learning in participants does not imply that they always have to work in isolation or solely in a formal 'classroom' situation. On the contrary, the construction of knowledge in tourism & hospitality studies can often best be carried out in collaboration with others in the field.

Sharing experiences, insights and views on issues of common concern, and workloads in collecting information through conducting investigative studies in the field (active learning) can contribute a lot to their eventual success.

Active learning has an important part to play in fostering a sense of community in an organisation. First, to operate successfully, a learning community requires an ethos of acceptance and a sense of trust among participants, and between them and their trainers.



Trainers can help to foster acceptance and trust through encouragement and personal example, and by allowing participants to take risks as they explore and articulate their views, however immature these may appear to be. Participants also come to realise that other participants and trainers are partners in learning and solving.

Trainers can also encourage cooperative learning by designing appropriate group learning tasks, which include, for example, collecting background information, conducting small-scale surveys, or producing media presentations on certain issues and themes.

Participants need to be reminded that, while they should work towards successful completion of the field tasks, developing positive peer relationships in the process is an important objective of all group work.

Identify training preferences

Considering the learner's needs

Your preparation for training also means giving thought to who will be attending. As well as the broad requirements of the group you are to train, you also need to consider the individual requirements of the group members.

One of the most challenging things about training a group is to be able to address the learning needs of all participants and take into account what unique circumstances they may bring to the training session.

People have a tendency to learn in different ways. Whilst there are some who prefer to watch, others are content to listen, whilst others still learn best by actually doing what they are being taught. A good trainer appreciates these differences and plans training which encompasses all these learning styles.

Know audience characteristics

Presenting the training in such a way that optimises the chance that the learner will succeed means there is a need to know something about the people to whom you are delivering training.

Not all learners have the same backgrounds and different people prefer to learn in different ways. The key is to get to know each individual and cater for personal orientations and individual differences so that you can capitalise on things rather than try to approach all training situations and all trainees as being identical.

Part of your preparation is to research the characteristics of the audience to whom you will be presenting.

You need to find out:

- How many there will be – this has implications for the type of activities you can select; it indicates how many handouts, samples, the amount of catering etc you will need
- The mix between age and gender – this has implications again for the type of activities, the language to be used, the examples to be referred to and the catering
- Details of any specific socio-economic details that apply – if the presentation is sales-related you need to match your products and prices to the ability of the audience to buy
- Seniority and status of those attending – to ensure deferential treatment of those who warrant it. In some situations your introduction may wish to acknowledge the presence of these people
- The level of existing knowledge they have about the topic that is the focus of the presentation – if the people are well-versed in a topic you won't want to bore them with information they already have/know
- What it is they expect to gain from attending the presentation – this must be one of the focal points for your presentation
- Any specific seating arrangements that may have already been committed to – this can have an impact on where you set up equipment, and how you allocate group activities.

Naturally each individual and group learns differently. It is essential, where possible, that both individual and group preferences for learning are taken into consideration.

Individual differences in training

Every group is made up of individuals, and trainers need to be aware that there is a need to cater for these individual differences. This applies if you are delivering training to a group of staff, or if you are delivering one-on-one training to individuals over a period of time.

Trainers often **wrongly** assume:

- Every learner at any one time is at the same stage of understanding or skill as everyone else.

If one staff member is ready to learn the next step, many trainers believe all learners are ready for the next step. This is not necessarily true

- One single method of training will be equally effective for all.

Individuals have preferred learning styles. For example, some will learn better by watching, some by doing, and some by teaming up with someone else, some by reading all about the task before trying it in practice. Some will learn better if trained by another staff member and not by the 'trainer'. Some people hate having to perform/demonstrate in front of others and others love doing the same thing

- Every trainee will understand with equal ease
- Because people are all at different levels due to their previous training, experience and background, it is a reality that some staff will find learning more difficult, and some will find certain training topics relatively easy
- The same amount of time needs to be spent with each learner to achieve the same result.

While we don't want staff to think we are playing favourites with them, it is usual for some staff to pick things up quicker than others, so it is important to spend only the time that is necessary with each learner to achieve your training goal

- New learning can be mastered by each trainee with the same amount of practice.

Experience shows no two learners are the same in their readiness for learning, their initial understanding of the work to be learned, their rate of progress through the training and their individual response to different training methods.

In most groups, you are likely to find some learners who are easily motivated, learn readily and progress rapidly, while others will require a great deal of help, but still progress at a reasonable pace. Yet again, some others will progress slowly, find learning difficult and apparently develop little interest.

'Difficult' learners may be casual staff who simply see their work as a 'second job', treating it merely as a means to obtaining some extra money. They may see training as a waste of time and something that unnecessarily interferes with other things they have to do – family, sport, relationships, etc.

All of this underlines why it is important to get to know your learners before you start training them.



Things about the learner's profile that you should try to determine before the training commences include:

Physical differences

- Are there hearing, sight or speech problems?
- What is their level of dexterity and manipulative skills?
- Are they too short or too tall for the training arrangements?

Literacy and numeracy

Not all adults can read or read 'well' and nor can all adults handle figures with ease.

In lots of work situations, there is no requirement for the staff to be able to read in order to get their job in the first place. But some may have literacy difficulties and their lack of reading skills may mean we can't rely on the printed word as a training source. You need to answer these questions about your trainees:

- Can they read your forms?
- Can they read internal paperwork?
- Can they price a bill?
- Can they work out the price for a list of items you have on sale?
- Can they calculate a simple discount?

What is their socio-economic status?

- What are their aspirations?
- What support or lack of support do they get from their family?
- What other commitments (sport, family, or study) do they have outside work?
- Does their background indicate that they value training and see it as worthwhile?

Previous learning

- What is their level of education and qualifications?
- What experiences have they had with in-house training?
- Will they be used to undertaking training or is this going to be a new experience for them?

Present status

- How long have they been employed with us?
- Is there a long history of non-promotion?

All these questions are not judgemental in nature, but simply provide background information you can use in order to gain fuller understanding about the focus of the training, the trainee and their motivation:

- Is the training regarded as solely related to work or can it be seen also as part of a bigger, personal development project, outside of work? The more you can relate a workplace training topic to a staff member's wider life (including their life outside of work), the better
- Is the training necessary for promotion?



- Is the training required in order to keep the job?
- Will the training be regarded as impinging on leisure time?
- Is previous training highlighted by success or failure?

The above all indicate that trainers cannot afford simply to see learners as some group of people who are all the same, called 'trainees'. They are all individuals, with individual personal baggage, individual histories and individual needs.

In addition, not everyone will learn in the same way. Some will learn quicker, better or more effectively if they read it from a book; some if they watch it on a video; some if they practise the job alone; some if they do it in a group; some if they watch a demonstration; some when they are trained by their peers and not by a 'trainer'.

This means you have to be alert to the 'little things' about the individual and cater for them wherever possible: not everyone will learn at the same pace, so be patient and don't mentally categorise slow learners as not as competent as others.

It should always be remembered the failure of the learner to learn is as much a comment on the trainer as it is on the learner. Perhaps more so!

Adult learners and learning

Part of being an effective instructor involves understanding how adults learn best. Compared to children and teens, adults have special needs and requirements as learners. Despite the apparent truth, adult learning is a relatively new area of study. The field of adult learning was pioneered by Malcolm Knowles.



He identified the following characteristics of adult learners:

- Adults are *autonomous and self-directed*.

They need to be free to direct themselves. Their teachers must actively involve adult participants in the learning process and serve as facilitators for them. Specifically, they must get participants' perspectives about what topics to cover and let them work on projects that reflect their interests. They should allow the participants to assume responsibility for presentations and group leadership. They have to be sure to act as facilitators, guiding participants to their own knowledge rather than supplying them with facts. Finally, they must show participants how the class will help them reach their goals (e.g., via a personal goals sheet)

- Adults have accumulated a foundation of *life experiences* and *knowledge* that may include work-related activities, family responsibilities, and previous education.

They need to connect learning to this knowledge/experience base. To help them do so, they should draw out participants' experience and knowledge which is relevant to the topic. They must relate theories and concepts to the participants and recognise the value of experience in learning

- Adults are *goal-oriented*. Upon enrolling in a course, they usually know what goal they want to attain. They, therefore, appreciate an educational program that is organised and has clearly defined elements. Instructors must show participants how this class will help them attain their goals. This classification of goals and course objectives must be done early in the course

- Adults are *relevancy-oriented*. They must see a reason for learning something. Learning has to be applicable to their work or other responsibilities to be of value to them. Therefore, instructors must identify objectives for adult participants before the course begins. This means, also, that theories and concepts must be related to a setting familiar to participants. This need can be fulfilled by letting participants choose projects that reflect their own interests
- Adults are *practical*, focusing on the aspects of a lesson most useful to them in their work. They may not be interested in knowledge for its own sake. Instructors must tell participants explicitly how the lesson will be useful to them on the job
- As do all learners, adults need to be shown *respect*. Instructors must acknowledge the wealth of experiences that adult participants bring to the classroom. These adults should be treated as equals in experience and knowledge and allowed to voice their opinions freely in class.

Flexibility in Learning

Flexibility in training and assessment strategies is required to meet the needs of participants who learn different or may have learning difficulties. The strategies used will vary taking into account the needs of individual participants however will be applied in a manner which does not discriminate against the participant or the participant body as a whole.

Catering for Participant Diversity

Participants have diverse backgrounds, needs and interests. When planning training and assessment activities to cater for individual differences, trainers and assessors should:

- Consider individuals' experiences, learning styles and interests
- Develop questions and activities that are aimed at different levels of ability
- Modify the expectations for some participants
- Provide opportunities for a variety of forms of participation, such as individual, pair and small group activities
- Assess participants based on individual progress and outcomes.

The diversity among participants also provides a good reason for building up a learning community in which participants support each other's learning.

Identify training barriers

Another important consideration includes identifying what kinds of barriers to learning participants may experience. These barriers can manifest themselves in three principal ways.

1. The attitude of the trainer, will be critical - are they properly prepared for the person or group in question and have you a positive and approachable attitude
2. Is the physical environment for training appropriate? Participants need to be physically comfortable or a huge barrier is in place before you even open your mouth
3. This relates to the actual group itself. As a rule adults will be internally motivated meaning they will resist ideas being forced on them. They also bring to training more life experience than children or adolescents and will require links to be made between training and their experience.



Describing available benefits and support

Involving stakeholders also includes describing the benefits and support available for those who engage with learning events. This may include, but limited to:

- Benefits that will flow from participation in training events
- Travel allowances
- Payment of fees and charges
- Per diem allowances
- Payment for meals and accommodation, where applicable.

1.7 Develop a schedule for implementing identified training events

Introduction

Once all stakeholders have been included in the planning process in relation to training activities it is now time to develop a schedule to implement the individual activities within in.

Context of training events

Training is usually conducted in a range of workplace contexts which impacts scheduling.

On the job training

On the job training during work hours where the training is regarded as part of the time worked by the employee.

This training initially takes place during quieter periods in order to minimise disruption to trade and reduce interruption to service.

Often this will build up to training in busier situations where actual workplace pressure can be added to in order to create a more realistic situation.

Before or after work

These times are useful because the equipment needed for training is usually available and free for training purposes rather than being needed for servicing customers.

When using these options you will need to take into account:

- Out of hours commitments the learner has – are they able to arrive at work early or do they have to drop children off at school? Can they stay back after their shift has finished or do they have a team sport they have to go and participate in?
- The fact the learner may be tired after their working day so training them 'after work' may not be a good idea. If they are tired they are likely to be resentful at having to stay back and be trained, and the chances are they will not learn as efficiently either.

In a simulated location away from the actual workplace

This can occur where the organisation has a dedicated training room, or it may involve moving off-site and using, for example, the facilities provided at head office, a supplier's premises, a recognised training provider (College or Institute) or some other business with whom partnering arrangements have been established.

Identifying specific days, dates, times and staff for individual training events at each location

A specific time and place for training must be organised with all stakeholders. As we have said, good training does not just happen, and it has to be planned.

The time and place should be agreed to by all stakeholders, in particular the learners themselves.



Note some establishments have a separate training room where training can take place, but actual workplace training is preferred by many.

It is a fact that training will tend to be ineffective if it takes place in an inappropriate location and at an inappropriate time. For example, it would be very unproductive to train staff in a bar during trading hours where there is a shortage of staff and has customers standing four-deep waiting for service.

Training should be conducted wherever possible in a comfortable environment and at a time when the learner will be able to focus solely on the information being transferred. This means the training location should be as free as possible from distractions and interruptions.

There should also be a lack of external pressure from customers and other staff. Therefore there should preferably not be other people standing around watching, or listening to what is going on.

Accommodating reason for the training

Where the coaching is urgently needed, staff seem more prepared to participate almost 'anywhere, anytime'.

Because they realise the urgency involved, they will accommodate nearly any time, date and location for training.

Also, the reason for the training will often determine what equipment and other resources are needed to conduct the training. For example, you cannot train someone in cellar operations in the housekeeping department!

Accommodating availability of location

The training room may be unavailable, or the workplace location in which you intended to do the training may be in use. This can often be a problem in role specific rooms such as the cellar, the bottle shop, the dining room, accommodation rooms and front office.

While there may be a room available, it may not be suitable for the particular coaching need, especially where specific items of equipment are required.

Likewise, certain training will require access to relevant stock – food, beverages, linen.

Agreement about a time and date for the training therefore needs to factor in the availability of a suitable location for the training and the availability of supporting resources to enable the training to occur.

Accommodating individual workplace operational needs

Service to guests and customers must take precedence over training.

This means it is vital to maintain suitable staffing levels at all times and not to compromise service levels because of training demands.

If you have to choose between training and serving customers, serving customers must always take priority unless there is a very real safety issue involved.

Other scheduling considerations

There are many considerations that must be taken into account when scheduling training events. These include, but not limited to:

- Accommodating individual learner preferences to the greatest extent possible
- Limiting training events and numbers attending to meet imposed budgetary and other operational constraints
- Coordinating the attendance of learners from multiple sites/departments at the one training event
- Identifying relevant training events that will optimise learning while minimising expenditure, including the need to identify local venues and training events wherever possible
- Communicating a draft schedule to learners and management/supervisors
- Revising attendance at training events, on the basis of feedback received regarding the draft schedule, to the greatest extent possible commensurate with achieving the necessary training objectives.



1.8 Develop an operational plan to support the implementation of identified training events

Introduction

Once a schedule has been prepared a plan must be put into place how it will be implemented and the involvement of support activities required to make them run smoothly.

Importance of making a plan

The more time spent preparing an operational and support plan, the better the actual training will be.

A lack of adequate planning is the single most common reason for poor training and ineffective training activities.

In practice, how the training activities goes, will depend 99% on the way you planned it to go. The critical importance of planning any training event cannot be over-stated.

Planning every coaching session is vital.

As they say, 'If you fail to plan, you plan to fail'.



Types of plans

Learning program

Training programs do not follow a one size fits all approach. Depending on the group and the subject matter the trainer must consider the appropriate response in terms of design.

Training organisations will normally produce a program strategy document which will outline in detail what the program will consist of and provide information on all relevant issues relating to organisation, resourcing and assessment.

In many cases there will be a need to develop a training/learning program for the entire year which will enable a series of training events to be delivered across diverse topics and covering a range of individual and/or intermingling standards.

Work based learning plans

Work based learning plans give an overview of the learning for a group or individual and involves on the job learning as the main approach but may also involve other types of learning e.g. off the job self paced or one to one coaching.

Individual learning plans

Individual learning plans are developed for an individual and feature a variety of learning approaches including work base learning, self paced (distance), face to face coaching or mentoring.

Session plan

The final type of plan that will be used is the training session plan which goes into the actual make up of a training session and acts as a guide to the trainer on timings, activities to cover and theory to teach.

Operational plan activities

There are a number of activities associated with the development of a training operational plan to support the implementation of identified training events.

These will be detailed in this section.

Allocating responsibilities

It is important that responsibilities for actions within the plan are allocated to different persons. This is the easy step. It is vital that these people:

- Understand their roles and responsibilities
- Have the time to undertake their responsibilities
- Have the authority to undertake responsibilities or make decision. This may also involve the delegation of authority and or the establishment of revised scopes of authority.



Enrolling and/or registering learners in training events

One of the key initial tasks is to ensure that not only are participants aware of scheduled training events, but that are allocated, enrolled and registered into specific classes or times.

Each training event will have an optimal amount of participants in which should be enrolled into each class to ensure they receive the most effective learning experience. Too many participants in a class, especially a practical class, may lead to less opportunity for participants to get individual instruction or practice. Too few participants in a class can lead to high training costs.

Not only are participants enrolled into specific classes to ensure optimal learning conditions. Other reasons include:

- Ensuring classes have an equal distribution of participants between them – you don't want one class with only a few participants whilst another class has too many people
- To help prepare necessary quantities of learning materials including learner books, equipment, tables and chairs
- To record names of participants – to identify if they have attended, to ensure they are paid and to issue certificates and qualifications
- To help identify amount of staff required at specific times to back fill operational positions.

Supplying learners with event information

Whilst the initial communication may involve the confirmation of enrolment and/or registration, it is essential that participants have an understanding of what will take place during the training sessions.

The information to be shared with participants will be explained in more detail in the next section.

This includes providing details of the training event and any necessary preparations and/or pre-requisites that apply.

Developing a continual learning framework

Whilst the primary objective of any learning activity is for the participants who have attended to develop their knowledge and skills, many organisations aim to develop a framework within which attendees at training events can pass on knowledge and skills learned to other staff in the workplace/organisation.

Not only does this reinforce learning but enables those who did not have the opportunity to attend scheduled events, to still have the chance to learn and improve.

Authorise staff rosters and payments

As mentioned throughout this manual, it is essential that operations do not suffer as a result of training. Therefore as part of the planning process, tasks include:

- Authorising staff backfilling arrangements
- Ensuring extensions to labour budgets to ensure additional staff can be used to backfill positions
- Arranging payments for those attending training events and those backfilling the positions.

Determining criteria to be used when evaluating post-participation in training events

Trainers and organisers of training events are always looking for ways to continually evaluate and improve training programs. Every aspect of the planning and implementation of training needs to be evaluated to determine what has gone right and what can be improved.

This evaluation process will be explored in more detail in Section 3 of this manual.



1.9 Share the implementation plan for training events with stakeholders

Introduction

Communication is essential when planning and implementing training plans. Each stakeholder plays an important part in the overall training strategy. Their understanding of their roles and what is expected cannot be understated.

Like in any activity within a hospitality organisation, each team member must work together towards an overall objective.

All stakeholders need to have an understanding of:

- What is going to take place
- When activities will take place
- What roles and responsibilities each person has.

Sharing the implementation plan

There are a number of ways to share the implementation plan. Regardless of which method is used, it is vital that:

- It is distributed in a timely manner
- All stakeholders have the opportunity to provide feedback and suggestions
- All stakeholders agree with the overall vision of the training strategy.

Using electronic communication

Using electronic communication facilities is a good way to communicate with all stakeholders, mainly participants in remote locations or with Head Office or external trainers. This method can include:

- Email
- Intranet
- Facsimiles.

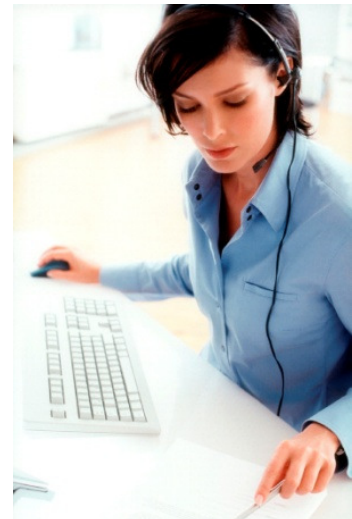
Providing hard-copy information

This is a common, easy and effective way to share information including:

- Letters to staff
- Notes in pay envelopes
- Posters in the workplace.

Discussing in meetings

In many cases, stakeholders may need a verbal reminder, explanation or chance to ask questions in relation to upcoming training events. By mentioning the training events at staff meetings and briefings, any detailed information or explanation can be provided.



Conducting training event-specific information sessions



In some cases, information sessions in relation to training events may be conducted. This may involve a wide selection of stakeholders, not just participants.

This method is quite common where the range of training events is quite detailed or incorporates many parts.

These sessions may also come in the form of team meetings, providing management and trainers the opportunity to discuss and iron out any details that may require further action.

1.10 Encourage identified learners to engage with established training events

Introduction

As training events are designed and centred around participants, it is important that they are encouraged and enticed to participate in any scheduled events.

Whilst one of the greatest influences is the ability to undertake fun and interactive training, during work hours whilst getting paid, training event organisers should always explore ways to motivate participants in joining training events. Just because an event is compulsory is not always going to get people excited about training.

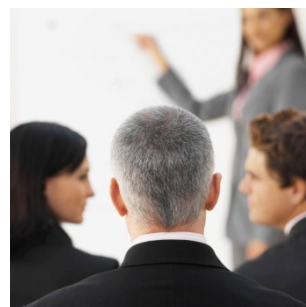
Explain purpose of training

As training is often associated with change, one of the major reasons for resistance by staff is the fear of the unknown. They may not understand why they are required to do training in the first place.

It is important that the purpose of conducting training is as transparent as possible and that learners are clear as to not only what they will be doing, but the reasons behind it.

Before a training event commences, the overall purpose of the training should be explained to the learner even though it was agreed to at the planning stage.

This explanation helps to set the scene for the training and serves to focus attention on what is about to take place.



Training must never simply be imposed.

Even though training is underpinned by a legitimate rationale, adults do not respond well to anything imposed on them.

Purpose of training

The overall purpose of training may be one or more of the following:

- To increase product knowledge
- To address a legally-imposed compliance requirement
- To increase workplace safety

- To reduce wastage
- To increase productivity
- To raise service delivery standards
- To change an existing skill to one required or preferred by the employer
- To prepare the learner for extra duties, promotion or additional responsibilities.



Tips to use when explaining the purpose of training

Suggestions to remember when preparing participants for training are:

They should be informed of the *need* for the training and how it will benefit them in their daily tasks. This will help provide fundamental motivation for the training and demonstrate there is a genuine need for the coaching

Where applicable, the learner should also be informed about how the training will benefit co-workers, customers and the business

The learner should be encouraged. As the trainer you must ensure staff feel you are there to *support* and *help* them.

Extremely high levels of interpersonal skills are critical for successful trainers.

Learners must feel confident and comfortable enough to ask the trainer questions. Any learner who feels uncomfortable with their trainer, or feels intimidated by them, will never learn to their optimum capacity.

To be clear about this, it is 100% the responsibility of the trainer to create and maintain this supportive and encouraging environment

Staff should be encouraged to be *involved* in the training session. This means all training sessions must be *participatory* in nature.

Adults learn better and quicker if they *learn by doing* rather than simply by watching or listening

The training session is being conducted for the benefit of the learner. Ensure you do not shift the focus of the training to yourself.

It is a common trap for trainers to begin to feel the training sessions are being undertaken so they can show the learner how smart or competent they are!

Remember: the training session is there to assist the learner, not to indulge the trainer.

Create a positive environment conducive to learning. The trainer must use excellent interpersonal skills welcoming the learner into a supportive and caring place where the focus is on fostering and cultivating.

This means the trainer will need to adjust the pace and flow of their training to meet the needs of the learner. Not all learners will learn at the same speed so the effective coach must modify their delivery to take this into account.

Explain benefits of training

As well as identifying the purpose of training, one effective way of encouraging and motivating participants to partake in training events is to describe the personal benefits to the employees themselves.

Some benefits of training include:

- Understand your role and what is required
- Have updated understanding of latest information, trends and practices
- Increased productivity
- Have greater confidence in performing your job
- Work in a safer manner and having less accidents
- Increased knowledge and skills in a greater cross section of operational areas and tasks
- Greater chances for tips or incentives
- Chance to earn more money
- Greater chances for promotion.



Change location for training

In many cases, conducting training in a different environment from where participants normally learn will be exciting for staff. This does not mean you need to go to a tropical island, but carefully selecting a place that will be comfortable and a change from their normal surroundings.

Incorporate fun

Training events are not just about participants improving their understanding of specific knowledge or skills, but is a great opportunity for them to learn more about each other. Many training activities try to incorporate fun team building activities which not only make the event more enjoyable but enable the team to gel as a whole.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 1.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to verify identified training needs
 - 1.2. To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to prioritise identified training needs
 - 1.3. To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to determine resources available to support training events
 - 1.4. To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to identify training events
 - 1.5 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to determine availability of learners to attend training events
 - 1.6 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to involve stakeholders in planning activities
 - 1.7 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to develop a schedule for implementing identified training events
 - 1.8 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to develop an operational plan to support the implementation of identified training events
 - 1.9 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to share the implementation plan for training events with stakeholders
 - 1.10 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to encourage identified learners to engage with established training events
-

Summary

Plan a series of training events

Verify identified training need

- What are we trying to achieve through training?
- Identifying training needs
- Training needs analysis
- Types of organisational staff
- Observations
- Interviews
- Questionnaires
- Job descriptions
- The difficulty analysis
- Problem solving conferences
- Appraisal reviews
- Drive pattern identity
- Organisational policy
- Overview of identifying training needs
- Verify identified training needs
- Verifying training needs with relevant personnel.

Prioritise identified training need

- Matching training need against workplace demands
- Factoring in legislated obligations
- Determining existing competency levels to cater for anticipated demand
- Determining costs associated with immediate and short-term training events to respond to urgent training needs
- Identifying the impact of not responding immediately to urgent need
- Identifying other priority activities that the organisation is required to accommodate
- Budget restrictions
- Identifying alternative short-term action, other than training events, that can be taken to address immediate priority needs.

Determine resources available to support training events to address identified training need

- Time
- Space/location and venues
- Human resources
- Financial resources
- Physical resources
- Externally available training events.

Identify training events that will address identified workplace training need

- Types of training events.

Determine availability of learners to attend and participate in identified training events

- Identify suitable times
- Liaise with supervisors
- Liaise with finance department
- Identifying peak and low trading times, days and periods
- Identify participant's time restrictions and personal affairs
- Identify productive times
- Consider additional time required outside of training hours.

Involve stakeholders in planning activities

- Types of stakeholders
- Discussing training event options with supervisors, managers and learners
- Involving the participants
- Creating participant centered learning
- Establish 'active learning'
- Identify training preferences
- Identify training barriers
- Describing available benefits and support.

Develop a schedule for implementing identified training events

- Context of training events
- Identifying specific days, dates, times and staff for individual training events at each location/venue
- Accommodating reason for the training
- Accommodating availability of location
- Accommodating individual workplace operational needs.

Develop an operational plan to support the implementation of identified training events

- Importance of making a plan
- Types of plans
- Operational plan activities.

Share the implementation plan for training events with stakeholders

- Sharing the implementation plan.

Encourage identified learners to engage with established training events

- Explain purpose of training
- Explain benefits of training
- Change location for training
- Incorporate fun.

Element 2: Implement a series of training events

2.1 Provide identified support for learners to attend identified training events

Introduction

Whilst planning and implementing training events is critical to the success of participant learning, there are a number of support mechanisms and provisions that also must be planned and communicated with learners.

It is vital that learners not only understand what they will actually be learning, but also understand how the events will be conducted and how they will be supported during the process.

Communicating facts, no matter how trivial they may seem, is essential to ensure that participants are aware of everything that will be taken place that everything has been arranged, what has been organised for them and what they need to bring themselves to training events.

Learners are notified of training details

As the trainer, it will be your responsibility to organise the training and then to let staff/learners know what is happening.

The information that needs to be passed on to learners regarding the training arrangements includes the following.



Timing

It is important to make sure that all the learners who need to attend training are informed about the timing and location of the training.

Ways to achieve this include:

- Verbally letting them know
- Putting a message on the staff noticeboard
- Using the e-mail.

When doing this make sure you:

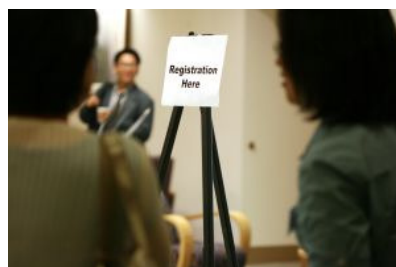
- Give the instructions in a clear manner – for example, does 'Training starts at 8 o'clock' mean 8:00 am or 8:00 pm?
- Let the learners know when the training will finish – so they can plan the rest of their day
- Start the training at the advertised time – it is a good habit to start on time, every time. This sends a message to learners, for their future reference, that they need to turn up on time, or a little before time.



Location

Give clear directions about where the training is to occur – this can be easy to do in smaller establishments, but difficult in larger premises, especially where there are multiple sites. You might need to consider giving:

- Street address
- Building name
- Floor
- Room number and/or name
- Details of any transport provided – where the training is held off-site.



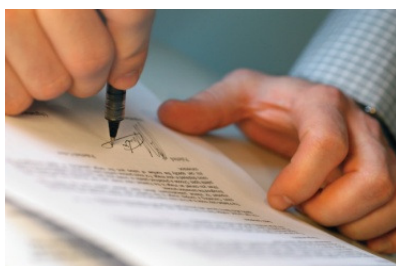
Contact details

- Include your contact details – so people can follow-up with you if required.

What to bring

Let them know if they need to bring anything with them. This can include:

- Paper and pen
- Training materials (if already distributed)
- Portfolio of work they are preparing
- Samples of work already prepared
- Personal protective equipment and clothing
- If food is being provided, let them know this, too.



People attending

Notify them about anyone who will be attending the training session and give an indication as to why that person will be there. This can include:

- List of other participants
- A guest speaker – perhaps you have arranged for an official from some government authority to come and speak to staff, or perhaps it might be a previous employee, or someone from your network of contacts
- A representative from a supplier/provider company – who is going to talk about a new product, give out samples, or provide their own company-based training for frontline staff
- A management representative – who might be going to talk about the performance of the business, a new direction the store is seeking to take, financial matters, or promotional opportunities for staff.

Support Information

Whilst each organisation and individual training events will have their own specific support information that must be passed on to participants, a list of common information includes:

Provide payments and reimbursements

In many training events there may be associated costs that either are to be paid by the organisation or by the participant. Where participants make payments, quite often these will be reimbursed by the organisation or paid in advance.

In either case the conditions of payments and reimbursements will need to be explained to participants.

These payments may be in relation to

- Transportation – including flights, taxis , vehicle hire or public transport
- Per diems – an amount of money paid to cover everyday expenses including meals, laundry and transport. Quite often a nominal amount of money is also provided as an incentive given that participants will be away from home for a period of time
- Accommodation
- Meals
- Purchase of equipment, uniforms or tools
- Visas and medical vaccinations
- Printing of materials.

Normally specific documentation must be completed, with receipts provided as proof of payment in order for purchases to be reimbursed.

Supply of pre-training event materials

Each training event will have some form of documentation or materials to accompany it. Whilst this can be distributed at the event itself, it is commonly distributed prior to the event to enable participants to read through any manuals or notes and become familiar with the content.

In addition pre-event reading and instructions may include:

- Logistical arrangements
- Preferred accommodation or transportation suppliers
- Background information
- Summary of event schedule and activities
- List of other participants.



Program expectations

There may need to be clarification with learners regarding organisational expectations regarding the training event. This can include expected standards of performance, behaviour, codes of conduct, uniforms or attire etc.

2.2 Provide required resources for supervisors to maintain required service levels during identified training events

Introduction

It is not just participants and trainers who require resources and support from training event organisers.

Given the fact that training greatly impacts the normal operations of a hospitality department, it is important that supervisors are provided with appropriate assistance.

Types of resources

Training organisers may provide required resources for supervisors to maintain required service levels may include:

- Authorising and/or arranging for supplementary staff to replace learners who are attending training events
- Modifying normal workloads to factor in the absence of traditional staffing levels
- Revising workplace activities to accommodate reduced staff levels
- Amending trading hours
- Closing sites, where appropriate
- Authorising the payment of overtime to normal staff to enable them to back-fill learners.



2.3 Advise learners of attendance requirements as required by the organisation

Introduction

As briefly mentioned in Section 2.1 participants must be aware of any rules or codes of conduct that accompany training programs. Each training session will have their own policies or procedures to hopefully ensure the smooth running of an event.

Attendance requirements

Attendance requirements may include, but not limited to:

- Punctuality
- Attendance for the duration of nominated aspects of the training event
- Active participation in activities
- Engagement with all aspects of the training event
- Undertaking assessment that comprises part of the training event
- Networking with other training event participants
- Returning to work with copies of materials or resources provided at the training event
- Focus on nominated training needs as applicable to individual learners, work sites, departments and/or the organisation as an overall entity
- Being able to demonstrate/prove attendance at the training event
- Completing an evaluation of the training event
- Sharing knowledge, skills and attitudes learned at the training event with other staff.



Confirm attendance of learners at training sessions

Without learners, no training session will be successful. In many cases potential learners may have been told well in advance about upcoming training and may have forgotten about the training or need a reminder. It is a good idea to follow up with learners to ensure they are able to attend.

This may be done a couple of weeks to a month before the training session to ensure that the learner does not make any other arrangements at that time.

Reasons for confirming attendance

Confirming of attendance is both beneficial to both learners and trainers. This activity is useful as it may be the last contact before the actual training session and it is vital that both parties are clear about the mechanics of the upcoming training session.

For the Learner

One of the key requirements of any training session is to ensure that learners:

- Are aware of training session
- Confirm that they are able to attend
- Can notify their supervisors if time off work if required, to enable them to allocate replacement staff
- Know all the details of the training session
- Understand all the session details
- Have received all the information they need before the session
- If there is any preparatory activities to be done by the learner, such as reading, research of preparing written documents, that they are aware of expectations
- Have any questions regarding the training answered where possible.



It is important that the learner is comfortable with what is going to happen in upcoming training sessions. The less surprises that arise, the more receptive the learner will be. Given that training is normally an area which is new to a learner, you don't want to have instances which may impact their confidence.

For the trainer

It is important that trainers confirm attendance as this helps confirm:

- Training room size
- Number of tables and chairs
- Suitable configuration of training area
- Amount of training equipment needed (e.g. kitchen stoves if cooking training)
- Number of training materials to prepare
- Number for catering purposes
- Any dietary requirements.



Methods to follow up

There are a number of ways in which to follow up attendance with learners. The method used will be dependent on the location of learners and the type of message to be delivered.

Methods include:

- Phone call – to get verbal confirmation and to enquire if the learner has any questions
- Email – if just a confirmation is required
- In person – whether individually or in a group situation (a specific meeting relating to the training session or as part of a shift briefing). This method is useful if materials need to be distributed and explained
- SMS – A simple text may be used to remind learners and to get confirmation of attendance in a simple and timely manner.

Keeping records of attendance

An important part of training is keeping records of contact with participants. In a group training situation this will normally involve a roll book or attendance sheets.

Participants seen one on one will still need to sign visit sheets upon which you will record details of your work with them. Most organisations will stipulate the need for carefully maintained records of contact to show the person's progress.



Before undertaking any training organisers need to ensure that you have the necessary paperwork ready. It is also important to remember that all written records concerning the candidates are confidential and should not be seen by anyone other than authorised persons including:

- Participants
- Trainers
- Participant's Manager
- Human Resources.

2.4 Capture feedback from learners on individual training events

Introduction

Feedback in regards to training programs is vital to identify the success of training programs in general and specific aspects in regards to planning and implementation.

Not only does it help to ensure that not only have participants found existing training events beneficial, but provides useful information on how to improve them for future implementation.

There are a number of ways in which feedback can be gathered in relation to training events.

These will be explored in this section.

Why evaluate training?

Delivering a training session can give you a great sense of achievement, as many first time presenters will tell you. But there is always going to be the concern of whether you really got the message across and people did in fact gain new skills and knowledge as a result of your activity. This will also have implications for the organisation as there will be an expectation that people have benefited from being with you and in turn so too will the organisation.



An honest evaluation will enable you to identify strengths and weaknesses in your own plan and also anticipate problems in future sessions. It is quite normal for trainers to treat their training sessions as a work in progress. Each session they deliver is evaluated and the results of this are used to implement improvements.

What do we evaluate?

So what are we actually evaluating? Effectively this process looks at four main things:

- The sessions success
- The Trainers performance
- The candidates experiences
- The outcomes achieved.

Methods to capture feedback

Written or verbal feedback

Feedback may be written or verbal in nature. The key to remember when getting feedback is to receive honest and accurate information, not what trainers wish to hear.

Many trainers and organisers therefore like to use anonymous feedback forms which enable participants to provide honest information without fear of reprisal.

Written feedback tends to be more formal in nature.

Verbal feedback is often used as an informal method of collecting thoughts during a training program and can help to ask follow up questions for greater clarification and suggestions in specific points.

When considering what an evaluation sheet should look like there are a number of key things you need to consider in terms of what to cover. Participants need to be able to comment on the overall program you were running and how well they felt it was administered.



This might also include comments on the venue, catering, training resources etc. Obviously the content of the training needs to be considered and whether it was pertinent to the needs of the candidate and if it met their expectations. Other questions could relate to the training materials and the ease with which they were used. Your own performance as a trainer also needs to be commented on so that you can identify anything about your performance which enhanced or detracted from the learning experience.

Finally, there should be an opportunity for the candidates to offer suggestions for improvements in the future. The actual design of these evaluation sheets will vary between organisations but if the above areas are covered, they should provide you with useful feedback whilst it is still fresh in the candidate's minds. This can then be looked at in conjunction with your own personal post session review and key conclusions drawn from them.

Compulsory feedback on all participation in training events

Most training events will have some form of formal evaluation in which organisers can gather information from participants.

An example of a feedback form is included later in this section.

Comments on relevance of the training event content

Whilst it is important that people enjoyed the training events, it is more important that they found it to be useful and relevant to their work. They must be able to take something out of the program that can directly and immediately be used for benefit in the workplace.

Explanation of the extent to which learners believed the training event assisted in addressing identified training needs

Organisers go to great length to identify learning needs. Section one of this manual has identified a range of activities used to identify and verify learning needs.

It is therefore important that the delivery of training events focuses on meeting these needs.

Ensuring feedback represents a valid profile of learners who attended the training event

Of great importance to the trainer is feedback from the group. Many presenters give out evaluation sheets at the end of a presentation to gauge the reaction of the audience to what they have just done.

The problem is that for many people who are training only occasionally it can be very hard to know how well the training has gone. In these cases you need to assess the audience as you go along and always remember the presentation principles covered earlier in this learner guide.



Whilst feedback from participants who enjoyed the program is helpful, it is important that everyone has the opportunity to provide feedback. Each group has a range of individuals each with their own learning style and preferences for capturing information.

By understanding how a wide range of individuals found the program, it helps to understand what activities or approaches can be enhanced or altered to meet the needs of the greater group in the future.

Trainer Self Evaluations

The process of evaluating your training does require a high degree of honesty on your own part. There will be times when the training you are conducting is not received as well as you would like, or some participants will be unhappy with your delivery. In these cases you must deal with any feedback in a positive manner and always look for ways to improve on what you are doing. With this attitude you will find that over time your performance as a trainer and the outcomes you achieve will steadily improve.

Practical applications in the workplace

Another way of determining the success of your training is to consider how well the skills and knowledge learned are being applied back in the workplace. Supervisor's reports and even appraisals can be helpful in gauging the longer term impact of the training you have conducted.

This will require you to conduct follow up investigations to determine how your participants have been faring with the new skills and knowledge you have given them.

Discussing concerns with training event organisers

Organisers will certainly be interested in how participants found the different training events. Having spent a considerable time and effort to prepare and run events, naturally they want to see how effective their efforts were.

Later in this section, information and feedback provided by trainers to stakeholders will be discussed.

Seek feedback from learners

The trainer should also ask for the learner's feedback on the training, and this feedback should be taken seriously and constructively.

Remember, everyone learns at a training session. Just because you are the trainer doesn't mean that you can't learn, too. Especially about the way you deliver your training.

Where problems with the training are identified, every effort must be made to remove them from future training.

Trainers must be alert to signs your training has not been effective. Performance problems or difficulties may be due to:

- Shyness or lack of confidence
- A breakdown in communication
- Language or cultural barriers
- Insufficient opportunity to practise
- An inappropriate training and practice environment.



The above problems can traditionally be traced to one or more of the following causes:

- Poor, insufficient or rushed preparation – remember that good training takes time and that the preparation prior to the training session is a major indicator of the success of the training
- Time restraints – it is common for workplaces to place unrealistic expectations on trainers, asking them to do too much in too short a time: where you genuinely believe you are being allocated insufficient time, you must raise this with management, explain your concerns and negotiate extra hours
- Communication barriers – including interruptions from outside sources
- Uncomfortable surroundings
- Inappropriate learning tools
- Broken, dangerous or faulty equipment
- Unmotivated learners – you will recall that a fundamental responsibility of trainers is to provide sufficient motivation for their learners: lots of learners attend training with no real motivation so it is up to you to generate it
- Insufficient stock, or consumables, to allow the training session to be completed as intended – this is commonly a budgetary constraint and where it is a genuine issue you must once again negotiate extra funding from management
- Poor levels of attendance – this may be due to poor motivation, or it can be due to the fact that supervisors will not release staff to attend training.

Following is a simple way to collect feedback from learners.

Training Feedback Form						
Session: _____			Date: ____/____/____			
Please tell us how you rate your training experience ranking in order 1 (below expectations) to 6 (exceeded expectations). Please feel free to add comments or suggestions. Thank you for your feedback.						
Area						Comments or suggestions
Relevance of the training to the company						
1	2	3	4	5	6	
Relevance of the training to your position						
1	2	3	4	5	6	
Relevance of the training to your career						
1	2	3	4	5	6	
Quality of the material presented						
1	2	3	4	5	6	
Trainer demonstrated good knowledge						
1	2	3	4	5	6	
Trainer developed good rapport with you						
1	2	3	4	5	6	
Were training objectives achieved?						
1	2	3	4	5	6	

Will the learning be of benefit to you						In what ways?
1	2	3	4	5	6	
Overall satisfaction with the training						
1	2	3	4	5	6	
Most useful part of the training:						
Least useful part of the training:						
Other comments or suggestions:						
By enabling learners to also provide feedback it enables learners to improve either their own training skills or to make the program content or delivery method more suitable and effective for other sessions.						

Feedback with people other than learners

As mentioned before, it is common for trainers to be required to give feedback to managers, owners, supervisors, other trainers, assessors and or the Human Resources (HR) department.

The feedback with these people may cover:

- Identification of learners who are showing themselves to be very committed, very competent, willing to learn and to have 'the right attitude'
- Identification of learners who are not displaying the right attitude – these may be those who don't show up on time, who skip scheduled sessions, who don't get their work completed on time or who muck around during training
- Explanation of where the money and resources allocated to training have gone
- Identification of problems that have emerged as part of the training process – such as lack of resources, timing problems, difficulty in getting learners released from their normal duties to attend training
- Identification of future training needs – perhaps based on requests from staff, changes to legislation, variations to workplace procedures, as a result of personal observation or on the basis of new business plans and directions that have been developed
- Explanation of the results of training that has been undertaken to-date – this might include:
 - Quantifying the number of people who have been trained
 - Identifying and quantifying the competencies that staff can now demonstrate
- Highlighting the benefits that the training has brought to the organisation, examples being:
 - Savings due to less waste and better use of resources
 - The flexibility to those drawing up rosters due to multi-skilling that is available
 - The extent to which staff training now meets imposed compliance requirements.



2.5 Modify planned schedule of training events on the basis of feedback and other issues arising

Introduction

Based on feedback collected from participants and other stakeholders, modifications may need to be made to improve the delivery of programs in the future.

This section will explore some of the modifications that may be made to programs.

Types of modifications

Modify planned schedule of training events may include:

- Adding extra learners to nominated training events
- Reducing the number of learners initially identified as participants in training events
- Asking training event organisers/providers to modify training events on the basis of feedback received, or changing workplace needs
- Seeking recompense from training event organisers/providers where the training event failed to deliver as promised
- Removing learners from generic training events and working with organisers/providers to create an organisation-specific training event
- Altering the style of training event with which learners will engage
- Discussing the potential to change facilitators used at training events where learners indicated this was an issue
- Advising training event organisers/providers regarding organisational needs/preferences regarding any aspect of the training event, including:
 - Starting and finishing times
 - Duration of training events
 - Activities
 - Assessment activities
 - catering arrangements
 - Plenary sessions
- Discussing impact of proposed changes on operational issues with supervisors, staff, management, customers, etc
- Communicating revisions to schedules to learners and relevant others.



Changes may be big or minute in nature. The key is to always look for ways to improve program offering.

2.6 Attend training events to monitor and evaluate their implementation

Introduction

It is important for organisers to attend training events, either for entire programs or just to gain a brief insight into how events are progressing.

Naturally trainers will always tell organisers that each event has been a success with all participants having a great time, however in reality this is not always the case.

By taking the time to get a first hand understanding of how events are running, enables you to personally see what is going well and what needs to be improved.



Many trainers may get worried if organisers come into training sessions as they may feel like it is a negative reflection on them. In many cases, this could not be more further from the truth. Most training programs are successful and by having an organiser there to see its success should be a compliment to the trainer.

A key aspect of monitoring and evaluating programs is to:

- Ensure trainers are aware why these monitoring activities are being done – it is not trying to find fault in trainers
- Ensure trainers know that sessions conducted by all trainers will be evaluated. No single trainers are being pointed out
- Try to make evaluation sessions spontaneous in terms of timing. If trainers know when their sessions will be monitored they may pay more attention to just these sessions, as opposed to all sessions which are all equally important in the eyes of both organisers and participants.

Monitoring and evaluation methods

There are many ways organisers can monitor and evaluate the success of training programs. Attending training events may include:

- Gathering first-hand opinion regarding applicability of the training event to identified needs
- Evaluation of specific aspects of events including:
 - Relevance
 - Currency of ideas and information
 - Presentation style
 - Techniques used
 - Value for money provided by the training event
- Evidence of appropriate planning by organisers for the training event



- Monitoring the extent to which learners interacted with the training event
- Talking to learners to gain their immediate thoughts on the training event
- Monitoring the activities, presenters, trainers, resources, etc used in the training event
- Actively networking with participants at the training event
- Capturing materials and resources provided at the training event for later use within the organisation
- Monitoring content delivered, and/or actions observed, at the training event with a view to using or adapting it for organisational application at a later date
- Providing tangible support for learners who have attended the training event
- Reaching conclusions about future use of individual training events in addressing identified training needs
- Providing input to the training event to optimise the likelihood that the training event will meet the identified objectives for each event
- Recording learner participation in, and interaction with, the training event.

Each organiser will identify aspects of the training program which they feel is of importance to them and the organisation.

By being an active part of the training process, helpful first hand information and feedback can be gathered.



2.7 Maintain contact with training event organisers/providers

Introduction

Trainers and event organisers should be in constant communication with each other, not only before and after the actual training sessions.

Both parties will have needs that need to be addressed which may involve the input or actions of others.

In the eyes of participants and those who have requested the training, they will only see the actual training event, not who has organised it or is running it. Their primary focus will be on getting the results they desired.

Quite often the organiser is the 'middleman' between the client (be it a department, Head Office or paying industry organisation) and the trainer. It is therefore important that any information or requests the client has is passed on to the trainer in an accurate and timely manner.

Addressing organiser and trainer needs

As mentioned, both trainers and organisers will have specific needs that need to be addressed and actioned before, during and after the actual training events take place.

Some of these have been identified below.

Needs of organiser

The organisers may need to communicate to trainers to inform them of:

- Client requests
- Suggested inclusions to program content
- Changes to program scheduling – classes may need to be changed or postponed. Some participants may need to attend work due to a sudden increase in operational demand
- Printing or preparation of materials
- Scheduling of different classes – this may directly affect the trainer's workload.

In addition organisers may need to gather information from trainers including:

- Reports on individual or group progress
- Attendance information
- Requests or suggestions for learning materials.



Needs of trainer

Like organisers, trainers will also seek or provide information to organisers. This may include:

- Request for learning aids
- Clarity on program structure and content
- Feedback on programs
- Timing of programs including breaks and meals etc.

By keeping each other informed of the progress of training events and the supply of support to each other, both organisers and trainers can ensure that the end clients are satisfied.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 2.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to provide identified support for learners to attend identified training events
 - 2.2 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to provide required resources for supervisors to maintain required service levels during identified training events
 - 2.3 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to advise learners of attendance requirements
 - 2.4 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to capture feedback from learners on individual training events
 - 2.5 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to modify planned schedule of training events
 - 2.6 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to attend training events to monitor and evaluate their implementation
 - 2.7 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify why it is important to maintain contact with training event organisers/providers
-

Summary

Implement a series of training events

Provide identified support for learners to attend identified training events

- Learners are notified of training details
- Support Information.

Provide required resources for supervisors to maintain required service levels during identified training events

- Types of resources.

Advise learners of attendance requirements as required by the organisation

- Attendance requirements
- Confirm attendance of learners at training sessions
- Methods to follow up
- Keeping records of attendance.

Capture feedback from learners on individual training events

- Why evaluate training?
- What do we evaluate?
- Methods to capture feedback
- Seek feedback from learners
- Feedback with people other than learners.

Modify planned schedule of training events on the basis of feedback and other issues arising

- Types of modifications.

Attend training events to monitor and evaluate their implementation

- Monitoring and evaluation methods.

Maintain contact with training event organisers/providers

- Addressing organiser and trainer needs
- Needs of organiser
- Needs of trainer.

Element 3: Review planning and implementation of a series of training events

3.1 Evaluate the impact of attendance at training events

Introduction

In the previous section we have explored the importance of collecting feedback from participants and methods to collect this information.

In addition we have discussed the importance of speaking with other stakeholders to gather information and suggestions and to discuss ways to improve the delivery of training programs and events.

Evaluate the impact of attendance

Evaluate the impact of attendance at training events may include:

- Seeking input from all relevant stakeholders
- Comparing pre-training event workplace practice, operation, statistics with post-training event workplace practice, operation, statistics
- Focusing on the criteria that were identified as being central to evaluating participation in training events in the planning phase
- Comparing the outcomes of attending training events with participation in more standard/traditional training delivery.



Feedback on learning plan

As mentioned, not only is it important to get feedback from participants, but also from fellow stakeholders are well. One effective way of gathering information is through a Learning Plan evaluation form.

On the following page is a copy of a Learning Plan evaluation form.

Learning Plan Evaluation Form

Instructions

Obtain feedback from your peers about your plan. Get them to complete the Learning Plan Evaluation Form below.

LEARNING PLAN EVALUATION FORM			
Instructions: You are asked to evaluate the proposed Learning Plan against which a training program may later be developed and delivered. Please complete the following form, ticking the relevant boxes and entering comments as required. Your recommendations will be considered towards the review of the Learning Plan prior to implementation. Name of Training Designer: _____ Learning Plan Title: _____ Version no: _____ Reviewer's name: _____			
LEARNERS	Yes	No	N/A
Are the learners clearly identified?			
Are all learners' needs included?			
If not, what other needs should be included? 			
PLANNING	Yes	No	N/A
Are the chosen units of competency appropriate for the learners and their needs?			
Does the content and structure address all aspects of the units?			
Does the learning sequence provide effective and manageable blocks of learning?			
Does the plan cater for diversity of gender, ethnicity and disability?			
Are the activities interesting and relevant?			
Will the activities motivate the learners?			
Can the activities be contextualised to suit learner needs?			

ASSESSMENT TASKS		Yes	No	N/A
Will the suggested assessment tasks adequately assess the requirements of the units of competency?				
Are the assessment tasks: Too detailed? ☐ Just right? ☐ Not detailed enough? ☐				
The suggested assessment tasks may be contextualised to suit learner needs?				
GENERAL		Yes	No	N/A
Does the program plan identify risks and contingencies?				
Is the timeframe suitable for the content?				
Does the costing represent an achievable/viable program?				
What are the strengths of the learning plan? 				
What are the weaknesses of the learning plan? 				
Do you have any other comments? 				
Reviewer's Name:		Position:		
Signature:		Date:		

Reflection of the Learning Plan

- Write your comments below of the whole experience including the feedback from your peers
- What changes may you subsequently make before submitting your plan to your client?

3.2 Assess the value-for-money provided by engagement with training events

Introduction

Money does not grow on trees and in each organisation; there are specific budgets for all expenditure items.

This is especially true when it comes to training events. Planning and implementing events does not come cheap and every manager wants to get a return on the investment they have made.

Unlike with other expenses, which can be directly attributed to the generation of revenue, investing in training may not have measurable or direct benefit on the bottom line.

That said, expenses should be tracked and ways to make training most effective explored.

This is the focus on the next two sections.



Tracking the costs

Training costs money. Even the most basic and shortest training sessions involve at least time: your time as the trainer and staff time for those who attend as learners.

The bigger the training commitment, the larger the training cost and there can be a need for you to be accountable for costs associated with training.

Depending on the scope and nature of the training, these costs can require you to monitor and be responsible for the spending of money relating to training delivery. Responsibility means that you should be able to prove expenses and provide documentary evidence of expenditure in areas such as:

- Staff wages in relation to those who attended training and assessment sessions – whether as learners, trainers, assessors, internal guest speakers, internal subject experts, staff who back-filled other staff while they attended training, or support staff who may have written notes, photocopied notes, etc
- Consumables – allocating materials and costs to individual training sessions: things such as notes, catering, and the raw materials and products used as part of the training and practice sessions
- Purchases and hiring charges – where materials and resources were bought or hired for training purposes
- Accommodation, travel and meals – where staff had to travel to an external site for training, or where you paid for someone to attend your workplace and provide training on-site.

Determining value

Not only is it important to keep track of costs, but to determine whether the costs are justified and be seen as 'value' for money.

When considering 'value' this has different meanings for different organisations.

For some value may be seen as:

- Increasing revenue
- Offering greater levels of service
- Developing staff
- Reducing accidents
- Reducing labour costs
- Improving efficiency
- Reducing complaints
- Increasing consistency in service
- Increasing customer satisfaction
- Strengthening brand value.

Each organisation will have needs and reasons for implementing particular training events. Regardless of what these may be, they still want some return for time, money and effort placed into training.

Assessing value for money

Assess the value-for-money provided by engagement with training events may include:

- Undertaking a cost-benefit analysis, including identification and quantification of hidden costs that were unknown prior to actual engagement with training events
- Comparing pre-engagement cost-benefit analysis figures with post-participation cost-benefit analysis, including identification of hidden costs that emerged when individual training events were attended
- Identifying alternative training that could have been provided at the same actual cost figure involved in participating in training events
- Obtaining positive and/or negative emotional issues experienced by learners as a result of engaging with training events.



One of the key benefits of undertaking an assessment for value, is to identify areas and ways in which costs can be more effectively used.

This will be detailed in more depth in the section 3.3.

3.3 Identify ways in which more cost-effective use of training events could be effected

Introduction

There are always ways to make training cheaper. The key point to remember is that costs should only be reduced without impacting the quality of the training. It is no point conducting cheap training programs if the participants don't benefit from the experience.

That said, by carefully looking at costs and thinking of creative ways to better utilise expenses, training events can be welcomed by all stakeholders alike.

Types of cost effective measures

Ways in which more cost-effective use of training events could be affected may include:

- Seeking group discounts for participation with future training events
- Organising internal training events and offering these events to internal learners and attendees from other organisations
- Undertaking joint venture/cost sharing arrangements with others
- Requiring learners to contribute to the cost of the training event, including free-of-charge provision of their time
- Working with the organiser/provider to present a shorter duration training event
- Developing a more structured internal approach to the sharing of knowledge and skills gained by learners at training events with other employees
- Use a mix of 'self study' and contact programs where the trainer is present.



3.4 Prepare a report on the use of training events within the organisation

Introduction

Progress on training may be reported in a formal or informal manner.

The precise method used in each instance will depend on the particular establishment's policies and procedures, but reporting is either verbal, written or a combination of the two.

Contents of a report

Naturally each organisation will have their own requirements and guidelines in relation to what information needs to go into a report.

Report on the use of training events may include:

- An outline and overview of the training events that were used, including rationale for the ongoing use of training events
- Identification of the costs involved and benefits that resulted
- Identification of numbers of staff who engaged with training events
- An overview of learners' evaluations of participation in training events
- Comparative cost analysis of providing learner training using alternative means
- Description of up-coming training events that have been identified as having the potential for future learners, including identification of training events that have already been committed to but not attended.

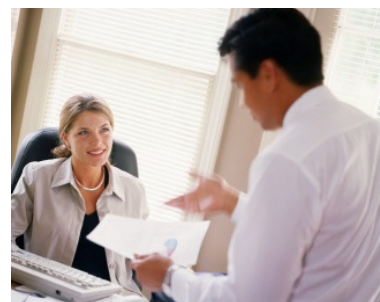
Who might receive a report?

Training results may have to be reported to a number of people.

Naturally the staff member who is being training should be supplied with an honest and comprehensive report of their training and/or assessment.

In addition you may be required to report to:

- Management and/or the owners of the business
- The HR Department – because the learner's remuneration may be linked to their capacity to demonstrate competency
- Head Office – for their records which may be used to identify staff who are eligible for promotion, further training, extra responsibilities, higher duties
- The supervisor in the area where the learner works – so they can get feedback about their skill levels, potential, commitment.



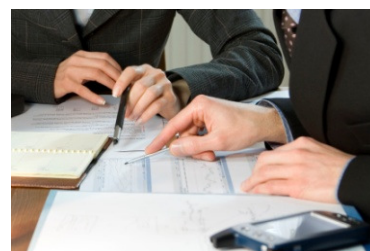
How often might the report be needed?

There is a wide variation of possibilities in reporting frequency.

Most establishments encourage 'regular' verbal reports on learner progress so this may be an almost daily chat with someone, just for a minute or two, about how they are progressing.

Written reports are usually required less frequently and may be needed:

- Weekly or monthly
- On completion of the coaching – that is, when you are confident the learner has achieved the required competencies
- For nominated staff or management meetings – where there can be a need for coaches to present a report on who they are coaching, and how those learners are progressing.



Why are these reports required?

These in-house progress reports can be very useful management tools in a variety of ways, some of which include:

Checking overall skill levels of staff

This entails keeping a current inventory of all in-house staff skills.

This can be referred to when there is a need to move staff around internally to respond to extra demand, staff absenteeism or unpredictable issues.

Recording extra coaching/training required. Reports are really records and these can be used to help coaches (and other staff within the organisation) identify, and remember for future use, the top-up coaching/training required by individual staff members.

Identifying those who appear appropriate for future skill development

Records can serve to identify future training or coaching needs for individuals, individual departments, and the enterprise as a whole.

A prime role of these records is to flag for attention certain staff who appear to have an aptitude for certain work, and/or to identify those who seem to have management potential.

Providing a reference for promoting employees

Success with learning can be beneficial for an employee's promotional prospects.

Amending employee's staffing record

As staff increase their skill sets their employee records should be updated to reflect their increased value to the organisation.

This increased skill level may be linked to increases in remuneration but is commonly taken into consideration when the business is looking to promote someone within the organisation to the next level of responsibility.

Compiling statistical records

Many establishments like to record details about the number of staff coached in a given period, how much time was spent on coaching and how much money was allocated to it.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 3.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to evaluate the impact of attendance at training events
 - 3.2. To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to assess the value-for-money provided by engagement with training events
 - 3.3. To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify ways in which more cost-effective use of training events could be effected
 - 3.4. To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to explain the purpose of preparing a report on the use of training events
-

Summary

Review planning and implementation of a series of training events

Evaluate the impact of attendance at training events

- Evaluate the impact of attendance
- Feedback on learning plan

Assess the value-for-money provided by engagement with training events

- Tracking the costs
- Determining value
- Assessing value for money

Identify ways in which more cost-effective use of training events could be effected

- Types of cost effective measures

Prepare a report on the use of training events within the organisation

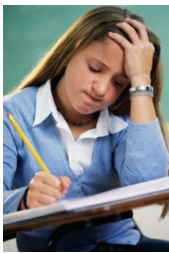
- Contents of a report
- Who might receive a report?
- How often might the report be needed?
- Why are these reports required?

Presentation of written work

1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final product will be well organised. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognise and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

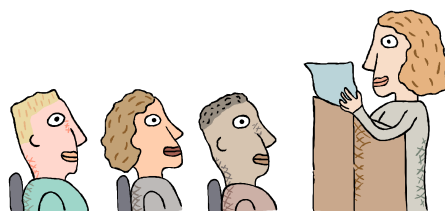
- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

3. Presenting Written Work

Types of written work

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



Format

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

Cover Sheet

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class/unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

Keeping a Copy

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

Inclusive language

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

Mankind	<i>Humankind</i>
Barman/maid	<i>Bar attendant</i>
Host/hostess	<i>Host</i>
Waiter/waitress	<i>Waiter or waiting staff</i>

Recommended reading

Brown, Douglas Robert & Arduser, Lora; 2005 (1st edition); *The Encyclopedia of Restaurant Training: A Complete Ready-to-Use Training Program for All Positions in the Food Service Industry*; Atlantic Publishing Group

Cannon, Debra; 2002 (1st edition); *Training and Development for the Hospitality Industry*; American Hotel & Motel Association

Dunn, D. M. & Goodnight, L.J., 2011 (3rd edition); *Communication: embracing difference*; Allyn & Bacon, Boston

Jazsay, Christine; 2003 (1st edition); *Training Design Guide for the Hospitality Industry*; Delmar Cengage Learning

Johnston, R & Clark G, 2008 (3rd Edition); *Service Operations Management*; Pearson Education

Kusluvan Salih 2003; *Managing employee attitudes and behaviours in the tourism and hospitality*; Nove Science Publishers, New York

O'Fallon, Michael J.; 2010 (5th edition); *Hotel Management and Operations*; Wiley

Sturman, Michael C; 2011 (1st edition); *The Cornell School of Hotel Administration on Hospitality: Cutting Edge Thinking and Practice*; Wiley

Walker, J, 2009, (3rd edition); *Supervision in the Hospitality Industry: Leading Human Resources*; University of South Florida

Zeithaml, Valarie A; 2009 (1st edition); *Delivering Quality Service*; Free Press

Trainee evaluation sheet

Plan and implement a series of training events

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

Please tick the appropriate box	Agree	Don't Know	Do Not Agree	Does Not Apply
There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency was at the right level for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I got enough help from my trainer.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The amount of activities was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training was well-organised.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer had time to answer my questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understood how I was going to be assessed.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was given enough time to practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer feedback was useful.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enough equipment was available and it worked well.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The activities were too hard for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐

The best things about this unit were:

The worst things about this unit were:

The things you should change in this unit are:

Trainee self-assessment checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer/Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer/Assessor.

Plan and implement a series of training events

		Yes	No*
Element 1: Plan a series of training events			
1.1	Verify identified training need	☐	☐
1.2	Prioritise identified training need	☐	☐
1.3	Determine resources available to support training events to address identified training need	☐	☐
1.4	Identify training events that will address identified workplace training need	☐	☐
1.5	Determine availability of learners to attend and participate in identified training events	☐	☐
1.6	Involve stakeholders in planning activities	☐	☐
1.7	Develop a schedule for implementing identified training events	☐	☐
1.8	Develop an operational plan to support the implementation of identified training events	☐	☐
1.9	Share the implementation plan for training events with stakeholders	☐	☐
1.10	Encourage identified learners to engage with established training events	☐	☐
Element 2: Implement a series of training events			
2.1	Provide identified support for learners to attend identified training events	☐	☐
2.2	Provide required resources for supervisors to maintain required service levels during identified training events	☐	☐
2.3	Advise learners of attendance requirements as required by the organisation	☐	☐
2.4	Capture feedback from learners on individual training events	☐	☐
2.5	Modify planned schedule of training events on the basis of feedback and other issues arising	☐	☐
2.6	Attend training events to monitor and evaluate their implementation	☐	☐
2.7	Maintain contact with training event organisers/providers	☐	☐

		Yes	No*
Element 3: Review planning and implementation of a series of training events			
3.1	Evaluate the impact of attendance at training events	☐	☐
3.2	Assess the value-for-money provided by engagement with training events	☐	☐
3.3	Identify ways in which more cost-effective use of training events could be effected	☐	☐
3.4	Prepare a report on the use of training events within the organisation	☐	☐

Statement by Trainee:

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

Signed: _____

Date: _____

Note:

For all boxes where a **No*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.

